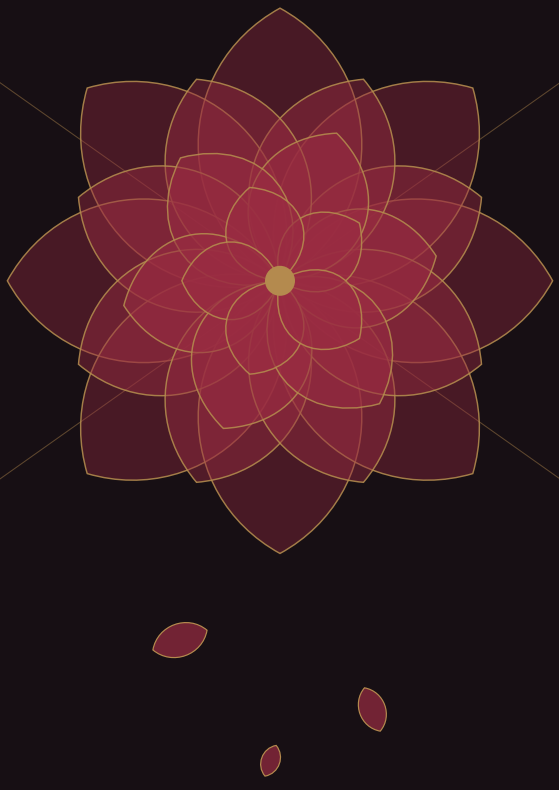
A DOCTORAL THESIS



Fiat Homo

The Anthropogenetic Contract and the Case for a Chiasmatic Humanism in the *Beauty and the Beast* Tradition

1740 — 2017

FIAT HOMO

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A *doctoral thesis*

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“L’homme n’est ni ange ni bête, et le malheur veut que qui veut faire l’ange fait la bête.”

Man is neither angel nor beast, and the misfortune is that whoever would play the angel plays the beast.

BLAISE PASCAL, PENSÉES

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Abstract

This thesis contends that *Beauty and the Beast*—in Gabrielle-Suzanne Barbot de Villeneuve's novella (*La Jeune Américaine et les contes marins*, 1740), Jeanne-Marie Leprince de Beaumont's abridgment (*Magasin des enfants*, 1756), and the cinematic avatars of Jean Cocteau (1946), Walt Disney Feature Animation (1991), Christophe Gans (2014) and Bill Condon (2017)—is the modern West's most durable domestic myth of anthropogenesis: a narrative apparatus for manufacturing "the human" out of a suspended animality. Its governing grammar, here named the *anthropogenetic contract*, makes the humanity of a sovereign masculine subject conditional upon the free consent of a woman whose beauty operates simultaneously as aesthetic, moral and exchangeable capital; it renders the labour sustaining the scene invisible, automatic or thing-like; and it summons the animal only to expel it. The tale thereby welds together two incompatible inheritances: the humanist doctrine that humanity is an achievement rather than an endowment (Pico, Erasmus, Montaigne, Pascal), and the contractarian-patriarchal doctrine that a woman's consent is the medium rather than the subject of that achievement—the "sexual contract" anatomised from Mary Astell to Carole Pateman.

Proceeding by a philology of concepts that reads each variant as an argument, the thesis reconstructs the tale's pre-history (Diotima's Eros, Apuleius's Psyche, Plutarch's Gryllus, the Book of Daniel, the *Roman de la Rose*, Scudéry's Carte de Tendre, the *conteuses* of the 1690s) and situates the two eighteenth-century texts within the *querelle de l'âme des bêtes*, the aesthetics of Hutcheson, Hume and Burke, and the canon-law theory of marital consent. It then distinguishes six successive *regimes of disenchantment*—*copula* (Villeneuve), *consensus* (Beaumont), *regard* (Cocteau), *aveu* (Disney, 1991), *récit* (Gans) and *grâce* (Condon)—which track the mutation of the Western theory of the consenting subject from the body, to the will, to the gaze, to the confession of feeling, to narrative self-authorship, to sovereign pardon.

Three structural remainders are identified. The *Gryllean remainder* is the persistent counter-desire for the Beast as Beast, running from Plutarch through the apocryphal "Give me back my Beast" to Angela Carter and Guillermo del Toro. The *lapidary remainder* is the line of conscious things running from Beaumont's

petrified sisters and Condillac's statue to Disney's enchanted furniture and the Code Noir's legal fiction of the enslaved person as *meuble*. The *fairy remainder* is the feminine sovereignty that authors both curse and cure before withdrawing. Read against Burke's *Enquiry* (1757), the tale emerges as an allegory of the Beautiful and the Sublime in which the learned woman and the beast occupy cognate positions of monstrosity—an *alliance of monsters* that the canonical ending dissolves.

The thesis concludes by proposing a *chiasmatic humanism*: an ethics of non-metamorphic recognition, assembled from Diotima's intermediary Eros as read by Luce Irigaray, Descartes's passion of wonder, Kierkegaard's duty to love the people we see, Iris Murdoch's attention, Merleau-Ponty's chiasm and Donna Haraway's becoming-with. In it, love neither manufactures Man nor consumes Woman, but holds open the crossing between the human and what exceeds it.

Prefatory Note on Texts, Translations, and Method

Villeneuve is cited from the 1740 text of *La Jeune Américaine et les contes marins*; readers without French may consult Jack Zipes's translation in *Beauties, Beasts and Enchantment* (1989). Beaumont is cited from the *Magasin des enfants* (London, 1756). Translations from French, Latin and German are my own unless otherwise indicated. Quotations from pre-twentieth-century sources are given in the original followed by a translation; quotations from modern works under copyright are kept to a minimum, paraphrase being preferred, and no lyrics from the Disney films are reproduced. Films are cited by director and year; classical texts by standard numbering; secondary literature by author and date.

"The tale" designates the literary type classified as ATU 425C; "the tradition" designates its transmedial corpus. Three procedures govern the argument. A *philology of concepts* treats each variant as a philosophical proposition with premises, cruxes and suppressed premises. A *genealogy*, in the Nietzschean and Foucauldian sense, seeks descent rather than origin. And the rhetorical figure of *chiasmus* serves as a hermeneutic instrument: the tale's recurrent crossings—ugly and beautiful, seeing and seen, master and mistress, human and animal—are treated as the loci where its argument is either held open or foreclosed.

The Beast as a Philosophical Problem

I.1 Three questions in one tale

Beauty and the Beast poses, in the idiom of the nursery, three questions philosophy has never settled: what is a human being, what is a marriage, and what is beauty? The tale's genius is to make each the condition of the others. The Beast cannot become human without a marriage; the marriage is invalid without consent; and consent cannot be given without a re-education of the eye that perceives beauty.

The French title folds the argument into a pun. *Bête* names both the animal and the fool, and the Beast of both eighteenth-century texts is not only hideous but, by fairy decree, forbidden to display his wit. Pascal's fragment is therefore less an epigraph than a key: "L'homme n'est ni ange ni bête, et le malheur veut que qui veut faire l'ange fait la bête" ("Man is neither angel nor beast, and the misfortune is that whoever would play the angel plays the beast," *Pensées*, Lafuma 678). To *faire la bête* is idiomatically to play dumb. The enchanted prince must *faire la bête* in order to cease being one, while Belle, the tale's angel, must descend toward the bestial in order to redeem it.

I.2 The corpus and the problem of "the tradition"

Folklorists classify the tale as ATU 425C, a subtype of "The Search for the Lost Husband" (425) adjacent to "The Animal as Bridegroom" (425A), whose classical archetype is Apuleius's Cupid and Psyche. The literary tale, however, is an artefact of print, salon and schoolroom rather than of oral tradition. Villeneuve's version, embedded in a maritime frame and running to well over a hundred pages, is what Elizabeth Wanning Harries calls a "complex" tale: digressive, frame-conscious and genealogically elaborate. Beaumont's is "compact": a fraction of the length, pared to moral essentials, and lodged in the dialogues of a governess and her pupils (Harries 2001).

The films inherit from both lines. Cocteau draws on Beaumont's austerity and Villeneuve's oneiric palace; Disney inherits Cocteau's invented rival, Avenant, who

becomes Gaston; Gans revives Villeneuve's revelatory dreams; Condon remakes the Disney archive itself. "The tradition" is therefore not a lineage but a palimpsest, and every reading of it is a reading of revisions.

1.3 The state of the field

Scholarship has advanced along three axes. The psychoanalytic was popularised, though not inaugurated, by Bruno Bettelheim's *The Uses of Enchantment* (1976), which reads the tale as the girl's passage from Oedipal attachment to the father toward an adult sexuality no longer experienced as bestial; Alan Dundes later documented the book's unacknowledged borrowings from Julius Heuscher's *A Psychiatric Study of Fairy Tales* (1963) (Dundes 1991). The socio-historical, led by Jack Zipes (1983; 1989; 1994), reads Beaumont's text as an instrument of what Norbert Elias called the civilizing process: a primer in self-abnegation preparing daughters for arranged marriage. Marina Warner's *From the Beast to the Blonde* (1994) restores the female tellers and the economics of dowry and exchange, while Betsy Hearne (1989), Jerry Griswold (2004) and Maria Tatar (2017) map the tale's metamorphoses across media and cultures.

The field's best-known text must also be weighed against its author. From 1944 to 1973 Bettelheim directed the University of Chicago's Sonia Shankman Orthogenic School, a residential school for emotionally disturbed children, which he presented in books such as *Love Is Not Enough* (1950) and *A Home for the Heart* (1974) as a model therapeutic milieu. After his death in 1990, former residents published accounts describing him slapping and beating children in his care and governing the school through fear and public humiliation. Richard Pollak's biography, *The Creation of Dr. B* (1997), assembled many such accounts from former residents and counsellors; some former staff and residents defended him. Pollak also documented that Bettelheim had misrepresented his training. His Vienna doctorate (1938) was in philosophy, with a dissertation on natural beauty in modern aesthetics; he had no formal psychoanalytic training and had spent the years before his emigration running his family's lumber business. In the United States he nonetheless presented himself as a psychoanalytically trained clinician.

His clinical theory bears on this thesis more directly still. In *The Empty Fortress: Infantile Autism and the Birth of the Self* (1967), Bettelheim argued that autism was caused by the parents, above all the mother: the decisive factor, he held, was a parent's wish, conscious or not, that the child should not exist. He likened the autistic child's withdrawal to the response of prisoners in the concentration camps where he had himself been held in 1938–39, a comparison his critics read as casting parents in the role of captors. The theory, popularly known as the "refrigerator mother" hypothesis, drew on Leo Kanner's description of autistic children's parents as emotionally cold (1943), and Bettelheim did more than anyone to spread it. It was

undermined by Bernard Rimland's *Infantile Autism* (1964) and overturned by twin research beginning with Susan Folstein and Michael Rutter's study (1977), which established a strong genetic contribution. Its framing of autism as a self that failed to be born has been rejected along with its account of the cause.

The theory's cost fell on families. For a generation, mothers of autistic children were told that their coldness had caused their children's condition, and some children were separated from their families for residential treatment, the Orthogenic School among other institutions. The theory is the anthropogenetic contract in clinical form, with its sign reversed. In the tale a daughter's love produces a man; in Bettelheim's clinic a mother's feeling was held to decide whether a child's self could be born. In both, a woman's affect is made the switch on which another's personhood turns—credited in the one case, blamed in the other.

None of this refutes his reading of the tale, which stands or falls on its arguments. It does remove the clinical authority on which much of the book's prestige rested, and it sharpens the reading's irony. The man whom former residents describe as striking the children in his care taught a generation of readers that a daughter matures by transferring her love from her father to a beast she learns to see as a man—the very passage this thesis anatomises as a contract. That the tradition's most influential psychoanalytic interpreter was trained not in psychology but in the aesthetics of the beautiful is a further irony the tale itself might have devised.

The ideology-critical axis concentrates on Disney. Susan Jeffords (1995) argues that the 1991 film is fundamentally about the rehabilitation of masculinity; June Cummins (1995) that its true protagonist is the Beast; a popular discourse, amplified around 2017, diagnoses "Stockholm syndrome." Meanwhile historians of the *conte de fées*—Joan DeJean (1991), Lewis Seifert (1996), Sophie Raynard (2002), Harries (2001)—have reconstructed the salon culture of female authorship from which Villeneuve and Beaumont descend.

These literatures share an omission. They treat the tale as a story *about* sexuality, socialisation or gender, but rarely as an argument *in* philosophical anthropology: a sustained, if figural, contribution to the question of what the human is and how it is produced. Yet the eighteenth-century texts were written in the decades of the *querelle de l'âme des bêtes*, between Bougeant's *Amusement philosophique sur le langage des bêtes* (1739) and Condillac's *Traité des animaux* (1755). Beaumont's tale appeared one year after Rousseau's *Second Discourse* wondered whether the orang-utan might be a man, and one year before Burke's *Enquiry* gendered the beautiful and the sublime. The present thesis restores this context and reads the tradition as philosophy by other means.

1.4 Five theses

1. *Anthropogenesis.* The tradition is a myth of the manufacture of the human, in which humanity is a status suspended, tested and conferred rather than a nature possessed.
2. *Contract.* The conferral takes the form of a contract whose operative clause is a woman's consent; she is the medium rather than the beneficiary of the humanisation she performs. Belle's "yes" functions as a secularised *fiat*, homologous to the Marian consent upon which, in Bernard of Clairvaux's homilies on the Annunciation, all creation was imagined to wait.
3. *Remainder.* Every disenchantment produces remainders—the animal desired as animal, the conscious things that labour, the feminine sovereignty that curses and cures—whose return organises the tradition's counter-history.
4. *Aesthetics.* Contemporaneous with Burke, the tale allegorises the Beautiful and the Sublime. The learned woman and the beast occupy cognate positions of exclusion from the beautiful, and their love constitutes an alliance of monsters that the canonical ending dissolves.
5. *Normativity.* A *chiasmatic humanism*—an ethics of non-metamorphic recognition—is the tale's suppressed truth, and the point at which feminism and humanism, so often opposed, converge.

1.5 Plan of the work

Part I (Chapters 1–2) reconstructs the classical, biblical, medieval and salon matrices. Part II (Chapters 3–4) reads Villeneuve and Beaumont. Part III (Chapters 5–7) reads Cocteau, Disney, Gans and Condon. Part IV (Chapters 8–9) stages the comparison with the feminist and humanist traditions. Part V (Chapters 10–11) formalises the anthropogenetic contract and proposes a chiasmatic humanism.

PART

I

Matrices

Chapters 1–2 · Classical, biblical, medieval, and salon sources

CHAPTER ONE

1

Eros Without Beauty

Classical, Biblical, and Humanist Matrices

1.1 Diotima's Eros and the Silenus

The deepest source of the tale is not a fairy tale but a philosophical dialogue. In Plato's *Symposium*, Diotima teaches Socrates that Eros cannot be beautiful, since one desires only what one lacks (201b–c). Far from delicate, Eros is hard and squalid, barefoot and homeless (203c–d): a *daimōn* stationed between mortal and divine, between ignorance and wisdom, and therefore a philosopher (204a–b). The Beast is Diotima's Eros given fur. He lacks beauty and therefore desires it; he is lodged, like the *daimōn*, between orders of being.

Beaumont's Belle names his philosophical status with precision. When the Beast confesses that he has no wit and knows himself to be "only a beast," she replies: "On n'est pas bête, quand on croit n'avoir point d'esprit: un sot n'a jamais su cela" ("One is not stupid who believes he has no wit; a fool never knew as much"). This is the Socratic paradox of *Apology* 21d—wisdom as the knowledge of one's ignorance—transposed into the supper-room of an enchanted palace.

The Socratic resonance runs deeper. Alcibiades compares Socrates to the Silenus figurines of the Athenian workshops: grotesque without, but opening to reveal images of gods within (*Symposium* 215a–b). Cicero records the physiognomist Zopyrus, who read stupidity and lust in Socrates' face; Socrates conceded the natural vices but claimed to have mastered them by reason (*De fato* 10–11; *Tusculan Disputations* 4.80). Nietzsche reverses the anecdote: Socrates was ugly, ugliness among the Greeks was almost a refutation, and his face proclaimed *monstrum in fronte, monstrum in animo* (*Twilight of the Idols*, "The Problem of Socrates," §3).

Between Alcibiades and Nietzsche runs the whole history of physiognomy: Giambattista della Porta's *De humana physiognomonia* (1586), with human faces paired to animal heads; Charles Le Brun's lecture on the expression of the passions (1668) and his zoomorphic drawings; Johann Caspar Lavater's *Physiognomische Fragmente* (1775–78). The tale belongs to this history as its most popular refutation—but a refutation with a twist. Having taught that a good soul may inhabit a monstrous face, its ending supplies the good soul with a handsome one. It is an *anti-physiognomic fable that ends in physiognomic restoration*, and that contradiction recurs at every stage of the tradition.

1.2 Psyche's lamp

Apuleius's Cupid and Psyche (*Metamorphoses* 4.28–6.24) supplies the narrative template: a girl surrendered to a monstrous bridegroom by oracle and family; an enchanted palace served by invisible hands and disembodied voices; nocturnal union with a husband she may not see; envious sisters; a transgression; trials; and apotheosis. It is told, significantly, by an old woman to a captive bride in a robbers' cave—the prototype of every later scene in which an older woman narrates marriage to a younger one, whether aboard Villeneuve's ship or in Beaumont's schoolroom.

Late-antique allegoresis, from Fulgentius onward, read Psyche as the soul and Cupid as desire, and Florentine Neoplatonism made the fable an itinerary of the soul toward the divine. In France the fable was revived by La Fontaine's *Les Amours de Psyché et de Cupidon* (1669) and by the tragédie-ballet *Psyché* (1671) of Molière, Corneille, Quinault and Lully, which together form the immediate literary horizon of the *conteuses*.

The relation between Psyche and Belle is chiastic. Psyche's husband is beautiful but unseen; Belle's is visible but ugly. Psyche's fault is to look—the lamp, the drop of oil, the waking god—whereas Belle's virtue is to look *through*. The tradition thus inverts the scopic law of its source: where Apuleius forbids the gaze, *Beauty and the Beast* commands its conversion.

1.3 Circe's swine and Gryllus's refusal

A second classical line descends from the *Odyssey*. Circe turns Odysseus's companions into swine (Book 10), and moral allegory from the Stoics onward read the episode as men's degeneration into beasts through appetite. Plutarch's dialogue *Gryllus* (*Bruta animalia ratione uti*) turns the allegory inside out. Odysseus asks Circe to restore the Greeks to human form, and Gryllus, a former man now a pig, refuses, arguing that beasts are more temperate, courageous and natural in their virtue than men.

The Renaissance amplified the refusal. In Giovan Battista Gelli's *La Circe* (1549) Ulysses interrogates the transformed men one by one, and only the last, an elephant who had been a philosopher, consents to become human again. Machiavelli's unfinished *L'Asino* includes a hog who prefers his sty, and La Fontaine's late fable "Les Compagnons d'Ulysse" (*Fables* XII.1) lets the beasts decline humanity as a servitude. George Boas named this current *theriophily* and traced its "happy beast" through Montaigne, Charron, Gassendi and Cyrano (Boas 1933); Montaigne's question whether his cat plays with him or he with her (*Essais* II.12) is its emblem.

This line supplies the first of the tradition's remainders. Call it the *Gryllean remainder*: the persistent suspicion that re-humanisation is a loss, that the beast may be better than the man he must become. Whenever an audience prefers the Beast to the prince, Gryllus speaks.

1.4 Nebuchadnezzar and the sovereign beast

The biblical archetype is the fourth chapter of Daniel. Nebuchadnezzar, boasting of the Babylon he has built, is "driven from men," eats grass "as oxen," and lives exposed "till his hairs were grown like eagles' feathers, and his nails like birds' claws" (Daniel 4:33, KJV). When he lifts his eyes to heaven, his "understanding returned" (4:34). The pattern is exact: sovereign pride, punitive animalisation, restoration upon recognition. The prologue of the 1991 Disney film, in which a selfish prince refuses hospitality and is transformed, is Danielic rather than Apuleian.

Machiavelli supplies the political theory. A prince, he writes, must know how to use both the man and the beast, as Achilles learned from the centaur Chiron, and must be both fox and lion (*The Prince*, ch. 18). Jacques Derrida's final seminars, *La bête et le souverain* (2001–2003), draw the consequence: sovereign and beast share a structural position outside the law, the one above it, the other beneath. The Beast of the tale is literally both—a prince whose sovereignty has been made visible as animality.

1.5 The humanist hinge

Renaissance humanism gives the tale its anthropology. In Pico della Mirandola's *Oratio* (1486), God tells Adam that he alone has no fixed nature: "Poteris in inferiora quae sunt bruta degenerare; poteris in superiora quae sunt divina ex tui animi sententia regenerari" ("You will be able to degenerate into the lower forms, which are brutes; you will be able, by your soul's judgment, to be reborn into the higher forms, which are divine"). Humanity is an achievement, revocable in both directions.

Erasmus's adage *Sileni Alcibiadis* (*Adagia* III.iii.1, expanded in 1515) generalises the Silenus into a moral hermeneutic: true value lies hidden beneath despised exteriors. Rabelais's prologue to *Gargantua* asks the reader to break the bone and suck out the "substantificque mouelle." Montaigne relativises monstrosity itself: "Ce que nous appelons monstres ne le sont pas à Dieu, qui voit en l'immensité de son ouvrage l'infinité des formes qu'il y a comprises" ("What we call monsters are not so to God, who sees in the immensity of his work the infinity of forms he has comprised in it," *Essais* II.30). And he turns the charge of barbarism against its accusers: "chacun appelle barbarie ce qui n'est pas de son usage" ("each man calls barbarism whatever is not his own custom," I.31).

The tale inherits this humanism whole—humanity as achievement, ugliness as Silenic husk, monstrosity as a failure of the beholder—and then makes a decisive substitution. In Pico the soul fashions itself; in the tale the Beast cannot. His regeneration requires another's judgment, and that other is a woman. Here the humanist anthropology crosses the patriarchal theory of consent, and the anthropogenetic contract is born.

CHAPTER TWO

2

The Rose and the Map

Medieval Allegory, Salon Topography, and the Conteuses

2.1 The rose and its querelle

The rose that sets the tale in motion is the most overdetermined flower in European letters. In the *Roman de la Rose*—begun by Guillaume de Lorris around 1230 and completed by Jean de Meun around 1275—the Lover enters a walled garden of Pleasure whose outer wall is painted with the figures it excludes: Hatred, Felony, Villainy, Covetousness, Avarice, Envy, Sorrow, Old Age, Hypocrisy and Poverty. Within, he fixes his desire on a rosebud, and the allegory's long labour ends, in Jean de Meun's notorious conclusion, with the plucking of the Rose: a barely veiled defloration. The poem provoked the first great literary controversy over women in European history, the Querelle de la Rose (1401–1404), in which Christine de Pizan attacked Jean de Meun's misogyny and obscenity against the humanist secretaries of the royal chancery. The controversy flowed into the long *querelle des femmes* and into Christine's *Livre de la Cité des Dames* (1405).

The tale reactivates this allegory with startling economy. A father enters an enclosed garden and plucks a rose; its owner demands, as the price of the flower, the father's life or his daughter. The rose is the daughter's metonym, and its theft is an anticipatory defloration negotiated between men. The structure is exactly what Claude Lévi-Strauss called the exchange of women (1949), what Gayle Rubin anatomised as the "traffic in women" (1975), and what Luce Irigaray, in "Le marché des femmes" (1977), described as a homosocial economy in which women circulate as commodities among men.

The Song of Songs supplies the theological counter-key: "A garden inclosed is my sister, my spouse" (4:12). The *hortus conclusus* was later appropriated for Marian iconography, with the rose as the Virgin's flower. The Beast's garden thus

condenses the erotic garden of the *Roman* and the virginal garden of devotion, and the father's transgression lies precisely at their junction.

The medieval allegory also unlocks the 1991 film's prologue. The beggar woman turned away from the prince's door embodies two of the figures painted on the outer wall of the garden of Pleasure: Old Age and Poverty. The prince enacts the courtly garden's founding exclusion; the enchantress's unmasking reveals that the excluded was beauty in disguise; and the curse condemns him to join the figures on the wall.

2.2 The Carte de Tendre

The second cartography is seventeenth-century and feminine. In the first part of Madeleine de Scudéry's *Clélie* (1654) appears the Carte de Tendre, the map of the country of tenderness elaborated in Scudéry's salon. Tenderness may arise from three causes, and there are therefore three cities of Tendre: Tendre-sur-Inclination, reached directly by the river of Inclination, and Tendre-sur-Estime and Tendre-sur-Reconnaissance (gratitude), reached overland through villages of conduct. On the road to Esteem lie Grand Esprit, Jolis Vers, Billet galant, Sincérité, Générosité, Probité and Bonté; on the road to Gratitude lie Complaisance, Soumission, Petits Soins, Assiduité and Sensibilité. Beyond stretch the Lac d'Indifférence, the Mer d'Inimitié and, past the Mer Dangereuse, the Terres Inconnues. Joan DeJean has shown how the map encoded a theory of female choice and of the slow, controlled conversion of acquaintance into love (DeJean 1991).

Beaumont's heroine, as Chapter 4 demonstrates, travels this map with uncanny exactness. She feels no inclination. The Beast cannot pass the first stages on the road to Esteem, since he lacks Grand Esprit and writes no Jolis Vers; yet Belle reaches Esteem by way of Bonté and Probité, and Gratitude by way of Complaisance and Assiduité. The tale is a *précieuse* itinerary rerouted around the river of desire.

2.3 The *conteuses* and the animal bridegroom

Between 1690 and 1715 the literary fairy tale was largely a women's genre. Marie-Catherine d'Aulnoy, Henriette-Julie de Murat, Charlotte-Rose de Caumont La Force, Marie-Jeanne L'Héritier and Catherine Bernard produced tales whose animal bridegrooms and enchanted palaces Lewis Seifert has read as "nostalgic utopias" negotiating the constraints of aristocratic marriage (Seifert 1996). Sophie Raynard places them within a "seconde préciosité" extending to 1756, the year of Beaumont's tale (Raynard 2002).

In d'Aulnoy's "Serpentin vert" (1697) the ugly princess Laideronnette, wedded to a serpent, reads the story of Psyche and is warned by it. In "La Chatte blanche"

(1698) disembodied hands serve a prince in an enchanted palace—the most commonly cited source for the living arms that hold Cocteau's candelabra—and the animal bride is disenchanted by decapitation. "Le Mouton" and "Le Prince Marcassin" multiply beast-spouses. Behind these stand Straparola's "Il re porco" (*Le piacevoli notti* II.1, 1550–53), in which a pig-prince murders two brides before the third accepts him, and Giambattista Basile's *Lo cunto de li cunti* (1634–36).

Antoine Galland's *Mille et une nuits* (1704–1717) gave the period its most potent image of the female storyteller. Scheherazade humanises a murderous king by narrating, night after night, until his violence is converted into marriage. The nightly repetitions of Beaumont's tale—supper at nine, the question, the refusal—are Scheherazade's nights rewritten as pedagogy, with the crucial difference that Belle humanises by listening and looking rather than by telling.

2.4 Two models of transformation

The most important intertext for the tale's philosophy is Charles Perrault's "Riquet à la houppe" (1697), itself a revision of Catherine Bernard's darker version in *Inès de Cordoue* (1696). In Bernard's tale the marriage of a beautiful woman to a gnome-king ends in adultery and in the king's vengeance of rendering her lover indistinguishable from himself. Perrault's Riquet is ugly but witty, his princess beautiful but stupid, and each can confer their gift upon the beloved. When the princess falls in love, Riquet becomes handsome—but the narrator reports that some deny any fairy intervention, holding that love alone made his hump seem a noble bearing and his squint the sign of an ardent heart. The moral is explicit: "Tout est beau dans ce que l'on aime, / Tout ce qu'on aime a de l'esprit" ("Everything is beautiful in what one loves; everything one loves has wit").

Here the tradition's central alternative is posed. Either the transformation is *ontic*—the beloved really becomes other—or it is *aspectual*—the beloved remains the same but is seen otherwise. The second option anticipates Hume's dictum that "Beauty is no quality in things themselves: It exists merely in the mind which contemplates them" ("Of the Standard of Taste," 1757). In another idiom, it anticipates Wittgenstein's analysis of the dawning of an aspect, in which nothing in the object changes and yet everything is seen anew (*Philosophical Investigations*, Part II, §xi).

Villeneuve and Beaumont choose metamorphosis; Perrault leaves the aspectual reading open; Cocteau, Carter and del Toro will return to it. The history of the tale is in large part the history of this oscillation, and the thesis will argue that the oscillation is not a hesitation of taste but a dispute about whether recognition requires the recognised to change.

PART

II

The Eighteenth-Century Texts

Chapters 3–4 · Villeneuve and Beaumont

CHAPTER THREE

3

Villeneuve, 1740

The Juridical Romance of the Atlantic

3.1 Frame, sea, and colony

Villeneuve's tale appeared in *La Jeune Américaine et les contes marins* (1740), a collection whose frame unfolds aboard a ship bound for Saint-Domingue, the tales serving to beguile the tedium of an Atlantic crossing. The frame is not ornamental. In 1740 Saint-Domingue was on its way to becoming the most profitable plantation colony in the world. Its sugar was produced by Africans enslaved by French planters and delivered to them by French slave-trading merchants sailing from Nantes, Bordeaux, Le Havre and La Rochelle—the city of Villeneuve's family and one of the principal slaving ports of the century, though nothing cited here ties her own kin to the trade. Plantation labour killed so many of the enslaved that the colony depended on the continual importation of new captives. The Crown codified the regime in the Code Noir, issued under Louis XIV in 1685: its forty-fourth article declared the enslaved to be *meubles*—movable property—and its thirty-eighth prescribed branding and mutilation for flight, and death for a third escape.

Villeneuve's merchant is a creature of this economy: a man of great wealth ruined by a cascade of commercial and maritime disasters, his fortune hostage to the sea that carries the narrators. The tale is told upon the very medium of the risk it narrates. That a story about a daughter given in payment for a debt should be recounted on a colonial vessel, in a world in which human beings were legally furniture, is the first datum of the tradition's political unconscious. It returns, two and a half centuries later, when Disney turns servants into furniture.

3.2 The *conteuse* as juridical subject

Gabrielle-Suzanne Barbot (c. 1685–1755) came of a prominent La Rochelle family. Married in 1706 to Jean-Baptiste Gaalon de Villeneuve, she sought a legal separation of property within months, her husband having dissipated her fortune. Widowed in 1711, she turned to writing for a living and spent her later decades as the companion of the dramatist Prosper Jolyot de Crébillon, who served as a royal censor.

The biography matters because the tale is saturated with law: contracts, curses with conditions, tribunals, statutes forbidding unions, and a long final section of fairy jurisprudence. Villeneuve wrote as a woman who had used the courts to defend her property against a husband. Her tale treats marriage as what it was in Ancien Régime France: a juridical act implicating patrimony, rank and family consent, not merely a union of hearts.

3.3 The palace as apparatus

The Beast's palace is a machine for producing spectacle and service without visible labour. Its windows open, by enchantment, onto the Comédie-Française, the Opéra, the Italian comedians, and the fairs and promenades of Paris—a device scholars have rightly called proto-cinematic. Monkeys serve as pages and perform plays, parrots speak, and meals and music arrive without servants.

These figures belong to their decade. In 1738 and 1739 Jacques de Vaucanson exhibited his flute-playing automaton and his digesting duck in Paris. In 1739 the Jesuit Guillaume-Hyacinthe Bougeant published his *Amusement philosophique sur le langage des bêtes*, half-jokingly proposing that animals are animated by demons—fallen spirits imprisoned in animal bodies as punishment—and was briefly banished for his pains. Bougeant's hypothesis is the enchanted prince restated as zoology: a rational soul condemned to a beast's body.

Against both stood Descartes's doctrine of the *bête-machine* (*Discours de la méthode*, Part V, 1637), which denied animals thought; La Fontaine had already protested it in his *Discours à Madame de La Sablière* (1678–79). Villeneuve's palace is thus an anthology of the animal question: the speaking parrot, the mimicking monkey, the automatic service, and the Beast himself, whose soul is precisely what the Cartesian denies.

3.4 The nocturnal Inconnu

By day Belle dines with a Beast who is kind, dull and laconic. By night she dreams of a handsome young man, the Inconnu, who pleads for her love, and of a noble lady who counsels her not to trust appearances. Her affections divide: esteem and gratitude for the Beast she sees, desire for the stranger she dreams.

Freud's essay on the universal tendency to debasement in erotic life (1912) diagnosed in men a split between an affectionate current, which idealises and cannot desire, and a sensual current, which desires and cannot respect. Villeneuve stages the same split in a woman, almost two centuries earlier, and resolves it narratively: the two objects turn out to be one. The dream is therefore not escape but evidence—a counter-tribunal of desire whose testimony the waking world must eventually ratify.

3.5 "Coucher": concubitus, consent, and the mandated fool

Villeneuve's Beast does not ask Belle to marry him. Each evening he asks, with a bluntness Beaumont would excise, whether she will let him sleep with her; each evening she refuses. When at last she consents, they retire together, the Beast promptly falls asleep, and in the morning she wakes beside the Inconnu. The disenchantment is *copular*: it is effected through the nuptial bed, even if what happens there is only sleep.

Canonists had long disputed exactly this point. Roman law held that "nuptias non concubitus sed consensus facit"—not intercourse but consent makes a marriage (Ulpian, *Digest* 50.17.30). Gratian's twelfth-century *Decretum* held that marriage was initiated by consent but perfected by carnal union, whereas Peter Lombard held present consent alone sufficient. Villeneuve's tale is Gratianic; Beaumont's, as Chapter 4 shows, is Lombardian.

The curse, moreover, forbids the prince to display his intelligence. His stupidity is an imposition, a role: he must *faire la bête* in the idiomatic sense, so that the woman who accepts him accepts a being apparently without wit. Pascal's formula is enacted literally. The man who would become human must first play the beast.

3.6 Fairy jurisprudence and the restoration of rank

The last third of the novella is a juridical and genealogical romance that Beaumont discards entirely. The reader learns that the prince, left in the care of an aged fairy while his widowed mother defended the realm in war, was transformed when he refused the fairy's demand that he marry her. Then the queen arrives and balks at her son's marriage to a merchant's daughter. Disclosure follows disclosure: Belle is not the merchant's child but the daughter of the King of the Fortunate Isles and of a fairy who married him against the law of the fairies, substituted in infancy for the merchant's dead daughter to shield her from a malevolent fairy. Belle's beauty is fairy blood; her virtue is breeding; the threat of *mésalliance* evaporates.

The same mechanism closes Marivaux's *Le Jeu de l'amour et du hasard* (1730), in which masters and servants exchange roles to test love across rank, only for the lovers to discover that both are of good birth. In each case the transgressive

hypothesis—that love might cross class—is entertained and then retired. The *dolce stil novo* had taught, in Guido Guinizelli's canzone "Al cor gentil rempaira sempre amore," that nobility resides in the heart rather than in lineage. Villeneuve's ending teaches the converse: a noble heart reveals a noble lineage.

The ending also discloses the tale's *fairy remainder*. Every decisive act—the curse, the dreams, the substitution, the final adjudication—is performed by fairies, overwhelmingly female, organised in something like a jurisdiction with laws and sanctions. Feminine sovereignty authors both the catastrophe and its repair. Yet at the close sovereignty passes to a king and a prince, and the fairies withdraw into the background of a dynastic marriage.

3.7 Synthesis: consent haunted by status

Villeneuve's tale is the tradition's most complex and most conflicted text. It grants female desire a nocturnal voice and makes consent the sole key to disenchantment; yet it subordinates both to bodily consummation and to the restoration of rank. Its heroine's freedom is real but haunted: her "yes" is valid only because, unknown to her, she was always the right bride. The first statement of the anthropogenetic contract is thus already compromised by status. Humanity is conferred by consent, but only among equals of blood.

CHAPTER FOUR

4

Beaumont, 1756

The Pedagogy of Esteem and the Grammar of Consent

4.1 The governess and the schoolroom

Jeanne-Marie Leprince de Beaumont (1711–1780) was born in Rouen, educated by nuns, employed at the ducal court of Lunéville, and married in 1737 to Antoine Grimard de Beaumont, a union annulled in 1745. By the late 1740s she was in London, where she worked as a governess and published, in French for English children, the *Magasin des enfants* (1756), cast as dialogues between a governess, Mademoiselle Bonne, and her aristocratic pupils. The frame is constitutive. The tale is no longer an entertainment told at sea but a lesson delivered in a schoolroom and followed by discussion.

Its lineage is Fénelon's *De l'éducation des filles* (1687), the Marquise de Lambert's *Avis d'une mère à sa fille* (1728) and, above all, Locke's *Some Thoughts Concerning Education* (1693). Locke had warned that a "foolish maid" who fills a child's mind with goblins and sprites can bind darkness and terror together for life (*Essay*, II.xxxiii.10). Beaumont's governess is the Lockean answer to the nursery maid of Perrault's frontispiece: she tells a tale about a monster precisely in order to unbind the association of ugliness with evil.

Beaumont was also a combatant in the *querelle des femmes*. Her first publication, the *Lettre en réponse à L'Année merveilleuse* (1748), answered a satirical pamphlet mocking women's ambitions by defending their capacity for reason and virtue, and her later *Magasins* taught girls history, geography and natural philosophy. Her feminism is pedagogical, Christian and rationalist. It argues for the education of women's judgment, not for their independence from marriage.

4.2 Bon sens against esprit

The compact tale turns on a distinction between two forms of intelligence. The Beast converses at supper "avec assez de bon sens, mais jamais avec ce qu'on appelle esprit dans le monde" ("with good sense enough, but never with what society calls wit"). The terms are loaded. *Bon sens* is Descartes's faculty, "la chose du monde la mieux partagée" (*Discours*, Part I): universal, democratic, the reason present in every human being. *Esprit* is the currency of salon and court—the brilliance of the *conteuses* themselves.

Beaumont's ethic of goodness over wit is therefore, among other things, a class judgment. It devalues aristocratic cultural capital, in Bourdieu's later sense, in favour of a Cartesian and Christian common humanity. The irony is pointed, since the tale descends from the most *spirituel* genre of the age. And, as in Villeneuve, the Beast's apparent dullness is mandated: at the end the prince reveals that the wicked fairy had forbidden him to let his wit appear. Belle's preference of goodness to wit is a test designed to be rewarded with both.

4.3 The gaze and the inversion of mastery

The first supper is the tale's philosophical centre. The Beast asks, "La Belle, voulez-vous bien que je vous voie souper?" ("Beauty, will you allow me to watch you dine?"). Belle replies, trembling, "Vous êtes le maître"; the Beast rejoins, "Non, il n'y a ici de maîtresse que vous." The exchange is a compact phenomenology of power. The gaze—which Laura Mulvey would identify as the structuring masculine privilege of narrative cinema (1975)—is here submitted to consent. Mastery is disavowed by the master. And the pun on *maîtresse*—mistress of a house, a lover, a sovereign woman—names the ambiguity of Belle's position: sovereign in a palace she may not leave.

Hegel's dialectic of lordship and bondage (*Phenomenology of Spirit*, 1807) explains the logic. Self-consciousness exists only in being recognised by another self-consciousness; the lord who reduces the other to a thing receives recognition from a thing and gains nothing. The Beast's renunciation of mastery acknowledges that his humanity depends upon recognition from a free subject, and therefore that he must make her free in order to be recognised by her. The inscription in Belle's apartment says as much: "Souhaitez, commandez: vous êtes ici la reine et la maîtresse" ("Wish, command: here you are queen and mistress").

Jessica Benjamin's *The Bonds of Love* (1988) reads erotic domination as the collapse of mutual recognition; Beaumont stages its prevention. Yet the freedom is architecturally bounded. Belle commands everything except the door.

4.4 Habituation and the watch

Love in Beaumont is not a revelation but a habit: "L'habitude de le voir l'avait accoutumée à sa laideur" ("the habit of seeing him had accustomed her to his ugliness"). Far from dreading his visit, she looks often at her watch to see whether it is nearly nine. The sentence is a treatise in miniature. It is Aristotelian, since virtue and its pleasures are formed by habituation (*Nicomachean Ethics* II.1). It is Pascalian, since "la coutume est une seconde nature, qui détruit la première" (*Pensées*, Lafuma 126). It is Lockean, since what custom has associated custom can dissociate, and the nightly supper is a deconditioning of the bond between ugliness and terror.

The watch matters too. It is the period's emblem of mechanical time, and its appearance signals that love is installed by repetition at fixed hours, regulated like a clock, before it is ever felt as passion. The clock that will become a servant in 1991 is already ticking in Belle's pocket in 1756.

4.5 Esteem, friendship, gratitude: the Carte de Tendre rerouted

After returning home, Belle reproaches herself in a monologue that is the tale's ethical thesis: "Ce n'est ni la beauté, ni l'esprit d'un mari, qui rendent une femme contente: c'est la bonté du caractère, la vertu, la complaisance; et la Bête a toutes ces bonnes qualités. Je ne l'aime point d'amour; mais j'ai pour lui de l'estime, de l'amitié et de la reconnaissance." ("It is neither the beauty nor the wit of a husband that makes a wife content: it is goodness of character, virtue, complaisance; and the Beast has all these good qualities. I do not love him with passion; but I have esteem, friendship and gratitude for him.")

Three genealogies converge in this sentence. The first is Scudéry's map: *estime* and *reconnaissance* are two of the three Tendres, and *bonté* and *complaisance* are villages on their roads; what Belle lacks is *inclination*, the river. The second is Aristotle's theory of friendship (*NE* VIII), in which the highest *philia* is friendship of virtue, distinct from friendships of utility and pleasure. Belle's *amitié* is Aristotle's complete friendship, and marriage is reconceived as its domestic form. The third is Mary Astell's *Some Reflections upon Marriage* (1700), which argued that since a wife must obey her husband she should choose a man whose understanding and character she can esteem. In its 1706 preface Astell asked: "If all Men are born free, how is it that all Women are born Slaves?" Beaumont answers Astell's prudence with a Christian twist: esteem may be founded upon goodness even where worldly understanding is absent.

The contemporaneous counter-ending is Françoise de Graffigny's *Lettres d'une Péruvienne* (1747). Zilia, an Inca princess carried to France, is loved by her benefactor Déterville, to whom she owes everything. She refuses to convert gratitude into marriage, offers him friendship instead, and chooses a life of study

and of the simple pleasure of existing; readers were sufficiently dissatisfied that continuations were written to marry her off. Graffigny and Beaumont take the same road on Scudéry's map—Reconnaissance—and part at its end. Zilia stops at friendship; Belle crosses into marriage.

4.6 Ordo amoris and the reward of virtue

The fairy's verdict ratifies Belle's choice in terms that are Augustinian before they are anything else: "vous avez préféré la vertu à la beauté et à l'esprit, vous méritez de trouver toutes ces qualités réunies en une même personne" ("you have preferred virtue to beauty and wit; you deserve to find all these qualities united in one person"). Augustine's "brief and true definition of virtue" is *ordo amoris*, the right ordering of love (*De civitate Dei* XV.22). The tale's moral architecture is a ranking: virtue over wit, wit over beauty. Its negative exempla are the sisters' husbands—one handsome but in love with his own face, the other witty but using his wit to torment everyone, his wife first. Narcissus and the satirist are the two disordered loves; the Beast is the ordered one.

The reward introduces a difficulty Kant would later formalise. In the *Critique of Practical Reason* (1788) the highest good is happiness proportioned to virtue: a union reason may hope for, but which cannot become the motive of moral action without corrupting it. The fairy is the tale's postulate of God, guaranteeing the *summum bonum* by adding beauty and wit to virtue. Belle chooses without knowing the reward; the child-reader is told it in advance. Beaumont's moral is therefore that of Samuel Richardson's *Pamela*; *or*, *Virtue Rewarded*, published in the same year as Villeneuve's tale, in which a servant's virtue reforms and then marries the master who held her captive. Henry Fielding's *Shamela* (1741) mocked that economy of virtue as investment; Beaumont shares its risk without its irony.

4.7 Statues and roses

The fairy's sentence on the sisters is the tale's most unsettling passage: "Devenez deux statues; mais conservez toute votre raison sous la pierre qui vous enveloppera" ("Become two statues, but keep all your reason beneath the stone that will enclose you"). They are to stand at the gate of Belle's palace, condemned only to witness her happiness until they recognise their faults—an outcome the fairy doubts. One may correct oneself of pride, anger, gluttony and sloth, "mais c'est une espèce de miracle que la conversion d'un cœur méchant et envieux" ("but the conversion of a wicked and envious heart is a kind of miracle").

Three readings are required. Theologically, the sentence sorts the capital sins into the corrigible and the nearly incorrigible, and its pessimism about the envious heart has an Augustinian, even Jansenist, severity that sits uneasily beside the

voluntarism of Belle's "bon choix." Morally, the punishment is a *contrapasso*. *Invidia* derives from *in-videre*, to look upon with ill will: envy is a sin of the eye. In *Purgatorio* XIII the envious have their eyelids stitched with iron wire; in Ovid, Niobe's pride turns her to weeping stone. Beaumont's envious sisters become objects that can only be looked at, condemned to look forever upon the happiness they envied.

Philosophically, the sentence belongs to the statue literature of the mid-century. In the *Traité des sensations* (1754), two years before the *Magasin*, Condillac imagined a statue organised like a human being but devoid of sensation, and endowed it with the senses one at a time, beginning with smell. Its first experience is a rose: to us it would be a statue smelling a rose, but to itself it would be nothing but the scent of the flower. Rousseau's *Pygmalion* (written 1762) would give the animated statue its first word, "Moi."

The tale's two transformations are thus symmetrical and opposite. The Beast is a mind sealed in an animal body, liberated by love; the sisters are minds sealed in stone, imprisoned by envy. Love animates; envy petrifies. This *lapidary remainder*—consciousness sealed inside matter as punishment—will reappear when the servants of the 1991 film are sealed into furniture.

4.8 1755–1757: the beast and the beautiful

The tale appeared at the densest moment of the eighteenth-century debate on the boundary of the human. Rousseau's *Discours sur l'origine de l'inégalité* (1755) located the human difference not in reason but in free agency and *perfectibilité*, and in its tenth note suspected that the orang-utans described by travellers might be men. Condillac's *Traité des animaux* (1755), against the quasi-Cartesian *Discours sur la nature des animaux* (1753) of Buffon, made the difference between human and animal one of degree. The same year saw the publication of the *Histoire d'une jeune fille sauvage* concerning the "wild girl of Champagne," while London still remembered Peter the Wild Boy, brought from Hanover in 1726. In 1758 Linnaeus's tenth edition of the *Systema Naturae* would list *Homo ferus* among the varieties of the human. In London, Beaumont wrote a fable in which a being judged a beast proves to be a man by his goodness and by his capacity to be loved.

The aesthetic context is equally decisive. Francis Hutcheson's *Inquiry into the Original of Our Ideas of Beauty and Virtue* (1725) had made virtue the object of a moral sense analogous to the sense of beauty, and Belle perceives the Beast's moral beauty through precisely such a sense. Then, in 1757, came Hume's "Of the Standard of Taste" and Burke's *Philosophical Enquiry into the Origin of Our Ideas of the Sublime and Beautiful*. Burke tied the beautiful to smallness, smoothness, delicacy and the passion of love, and the sublime to vastness, obscurity, power and terror; beauty in women, he argued, is bound up with weakness and delicacy.

The Beast—enormous, dark, terrifying, master of a remote and obscure domain—is Burke's sublime; Belle is his beautiful. *La Belle et la Bête* is, among other things, *le Beau et le Sublime*, and its transformation domesticates the sublime into the beautiful. Mary Wollstonecraft saw what was at stake. In *A Vindication of the Rights of Men* (1790) she charged Burke with persuading women that "littleness and weakness are the very essence of beauty."

Kant completed the gendering. His *Observations on the Feeling of the Beautiful and Sublime* (1764) assigned the beautiful to women and the sublime to men, and warned that a woman with a head full of Greek, like Madame Dacier, or who disputes mechanics, like the Marquise du Châtelet, might as well wear a beard. In "What Is Enlightenment?" (1784) he observed that the greater part of humanity, "darunter das ganze schöne Geschlecht"—including the entire *beautiful sex*—regards the step to maturity as dangerous, because guardians have made it so. Belle is the beautiful sex personified.

Kant's bearded learned woman and the hairy Beast share a position. Both are expelled from the beautiful into monstrosity, the one for thinking, the other for looking like an animal. Their love is therefore an *alliance of monsters*, and the tale lets it form only to dissolve it, returning the Beast to beauty and Belle to the beautiful sex.

4.9 Consensus facit nuptias

Beaumont's most consequential revision is a single question. Where Villeneuve's Beast asks to sleep with Belle, Beaumont's asks, "La Belle, voulez-vous être ma femme?" The disenchantment ceases to be copular and becomes consensual: no sooner does Belle pledge herself than the palace blazes with light, music and fireworks. Beaumont has moved the tale from Gratian to Peter Lombard, from *concubitus* to *consensus*, in conformity with Ulpian's maxim. The modernising gesture is also a purification. Consent alone, uttered as a speech act, transforms the world, and the anthropogenetic contract appears in its purest form.

Purity sharpens the problem. Belle's consent is given in a palace she entered as surety for her father's debt, to a being on whom her family's fortune depends, after a dream in which he dies of her ingratitude, and as he lies starving by the canal. It is free in the voluntarist sense—no one compels her—and constrained in every material and affective sense. Carole Pateman's *The Sexual Contract* (1988) argued that the social contract presupposes a prior sexual contract instituting men's access to women's bodies, and that the language of free contract masks subordination. Astell had already put the question to Locke's generation: "If absolute Sovereignty be not necessary in a State, how comes it to be so in a Family?"

Beaumont's tale is the most beautiful version of the sexual contract ever written, because in it the contract appears not as subjection but as grace. Belle's "yes" makes a man. That is its glory and its cost.

PART

III

The Cinematic Afterlives

Chapters 5–7 · Cocteau, Disney, Gans, and Condon

CHAPTER FIVE

5

Cocteau, 1946

The Look of Love in the Year of the Purge

5.1 A fairy tale after the Liberation

Jean Cocteau shot *La Belle et la Bête* between August 1945 and January 1946, amid power cuts and rationed film stock, in a France conducting its *épuration*. The purge had a gendered iconography. Between 1943 and 1946, by Fabrice Virgili's count, some 20,000 French women had their heads shaved in public as punishment for alleged collaboration—many for sexual relationships with German soldiers, the so-called *collaboration horizontale*, others for denunciation, for working for the occupier, or for political collaboration. The shearing was done by their compatriots: local résistants, members of the FFI and self-appointed purgers, almost all of them men, before crowds of neighbours, and the women were often paraded through the streets afterwards (Virgili 2000). Cocteau's own record was compromised. In May 1942 he had published "Salut à Breker" in *Comœdia*, an admiring tribute to Arno Breker, Hitler's favoured sculptor, whose Paris exhibition was a showcase of the occupier's culture. Jean Marais, Cocteau's companion and the film's star, had famously assaulted Alain Laubreaux, critic for the collaborationist and antisemitic weekly *Je suis partout*, and in 1944 enlisted with Leclerc's Second Armoured Division.

Cocteau's production diary, published as *La Belle et la Bête: journal d'un film* (1946), records the shoot as an ordeal of the body: illness, exhaustion, and a skin disease that kept him in pain for weeks. A film about a creature whose skin makes him an outcast, hunted by a band of handsome young men, was made in the year French crowds marked women's bodies as the visible site of the nation's guilt. The parallel must be stated with its asymmetry. The public punishment of the purge fell on women and was inflicted by men; Cocteau, whose praise of Breker was a matter

of record, suffered nothing comparable. By lodging stigma in a male beast who proves the noblest heart in the kingdom, the film protests the logic of the shaved head while re-gendering its victim, and it offers its compromised author an allegory of his own exoneration. The tradition's habit of making a woman the medium of a man's redemption is here doubled by history: the women who bore the stigma in 1945 are absent from the fable that redeems it.

The film opens with a written appeal to the audience to recover a child's faith, a credulity that does not ask how the magic is done—Cocteau's answer, in effect, to a culture of suspicion. Its effects are artisanal: slow and reversed motion, mirrors, black velvet, living actors embedded in the décor. André Bazin's "Ontologie de l'image photographique," published in 1945, grounded cinema in the photograph's indexical bond with the real. Cocteau's magic is indexical too—a real arm thrust through a real wall—and the film's wonder is that of reality made strange rather than of illusion manufactured.

5.2 Two economies of labour

Christian Bérard's design and Henri Alekan's photography split the film into two visual worlds. Belle's home is lit after Vermeer: white linen, stone floors, laundry, a daughter scrubbing while her sisters preen. Labour here is visible, feminine and exploited, and Belle is Cinderella before she is Psyche. The Beast's castle, shot partly at the Château de Raray with its sculpted hunt, is drawn from Gustave Doré: shadow and smoke, statues whose eyes follow, faces in the chimney-piece, and human arms that emerge from the walls to hold candelabra and pour wine.

The arms descend from d'Aulnoy's "Chatte blanche" and from Apuleius's invisible servants, and they make an argument. In the merchant's house labour is a whole body; in the Beast's house it is a fragment. The aristocratic fantasy of service without servants takes the surrealist form of dismemberment—the servant reduced to a function, the function reduced to a limb. Disney will complete the reduction by replacing the limb with the object.

5.3 Diana's pavilion: Actaeon and Bluebeard

Cocteau adds a mythological machine absent from his sources. The Beast's treasure lies in the Pavillon de Diane, whose golden key he entrusts to Belle: if she betrays him, he will die. The motif is the forbidden chamber of Perrault's "Barbe bleue," but the goddess is Ovid's. In *Metamorphoses* III, the hunter Actaeon sees Diana bathing and is transformed into a stag and torn apart by his own hounds.

Cocteau's Avenant—the handsome suitor who conspires with Belle's brother to rob the pavilion—breaks through its glass roof and is struck by an arrow loosed by the statue of Diana. As he falls he becomes the Beast, while the Beast rises

transfigured as Prince Ardent, wearing Avenant's face. Cocteau thereby reroutes the curse through the myth of the transgressive gaze punished by animalisation. Acquisitive masculine looking and violence, rather than an old fairy's pique, are what make men beasts.

5.4 One actor, three bodies

Marais plays Avenant, the Beast and the Prince, collapsing into a single body the triangle Eve Kosofsky Sedgwick would later analyse as the homosocial structure of the European novel, in which rivalry between men is mediated through a woman (Sedgwick 1985). Belle's choice between the handsome brute and the courteous monster is a choice between two forms of one man, and the ending grants her the brute's face with the monster's soul.

Her reception of the transfigured prince is famously muted, closer to acquiescence than rapture. The lore of the film—an exclamation, apocryphal and variously attributed, most often to Greta Garbo, demanding the return of the Beast—records audiences' sense of loss. Read through the partnership of Cocteau and Marais, the disappointment acquires a queer valence. The prince is the norm returning; the Beast, whose devotion never quite reads as ordinary heterosexual appetite, figures a love the norm cannot house. The Gryllean remainder finds here its first great cinematic expression: the transformation is staged, and it is staged as a loss.

5.5 The look of love

Cocteau's Beast is defined by shame before the gaze. He forbids Belle to look into his eyes; smoke rises from his hands after the kill; the scene in which he drinks from her cupped palms like an animal is played as a crisis of shame and tenderness at once. As the prince explains at the close, only a look of love could save him. The film's mechanism of disenchantment is therefore *scopic*: neither copula nor contract, but a way of seeing.

The philosophical context is exact. In *L'Être et le néant* (1943), Sartre had analysed the look of the Other as objectifying: under the gaze I become a thing, shame is the recognition that I am as the Other sees me, and love is a doomed project to capture the freedom of the one who looks. On 29 October 1945, while Cocteau was shooting, Sartre lectured in Paris on *L'existentialisme est un humanisme*, declaring that there is no human nature and that man is nothing but what he makes of himself. Heidegger replied in the *Brief über den Humanismus* (1946–47), rejecting the metaphysical definition of man as *animal rationale* for thinking the human from the side of animality.

Cocteau's film intervenes in this postwar crisis of humanism with a counter-thesis. The look need not objectify; a look of love can constitute. Humanity is neither an essence—the Beast's good heart does not suffice—nor a self-made project—he cannot will himself free—but a gift conferred by a regard. The film thus refutes Sartre on love while conceding Sartre's premise that the human is made, not given.

Simone de Beauvoir's *Le Deuxième Sexe* (1949) arrived three years later to name the cost. Its chapters on myth show woman cast as the Other through whom man attains transcendence: Beatrice leading Dante, the Eternal Feminine that, in the last line of Goethe's *Faust*, draws us upward. Cocteau's Belle is that mediator; her gaze is the instrument of a man's redemption. The film's ambivalent close concedes, without resolving, that the woman who saves the Beast loses the one being who needed her as she was.

5.6 Synthesis

Cocteau's film is the tradition's hinge between literature and mass cinema, and between metamorphosis and its critique. It retains the canonical structure while undermining it from within: the human is restored, but with the face of the villain; the look of love saves, but what it saves is a disappointment. Cocteau inaugurates, inside the form itself, the counter-tradition this thesis calls the Gryllean remainder, and he establishes the regime of *regard* that the cinema will never entirely abandon.

CHAPTER SIX

6

Disney, 1991

Reading Belle, Reifying the Household, Hunting the Beast

6.1 Authorship, form, and the bestiary

Walt Disney Feature Animation's *Beauty and the Beast* (dir. Gary Trousdale and Kirk Wise, 1991) consolidated the studio's renaissance after *The Little Mermaid* (1989). Its screenplay was written by Linda Woolverton, the first woman to write a Disney animated feature, who has described shaping Belle after the spirited, bookish heroines of *Little Women*; its songs, by Howard Ashman and Alan Menken, gave it the architecture of a Broadway book musical. It became the first animated feature nominated for the Academy Award for Best Picture. The film is the tradition's most influential text since Beaumont, and the one through which most living people know the tale.

Glen Keane's design for the Beast compounds a buffalo's head and beard, a lion's mane, a gorilla's brow, a boar's tusks, a bear's body, and a wolf's legs and tail. The Beast is not an animal but the animal kingdom: a Linnaean taxonomy collapsed into one body, the heir of della Porta's and Le Brun's zoo-physiognomics. Where Villeneuve's palace was an anthology of the animal question, Disney's Beast is its bestiary.

6.2 The reader in the provinces

Woolverton's decisive innovation is to make Belle a reader. The opening number presents her, through the chorus of a provincial town, as beautiful but peculiar, her nose always in a book. The romance she loves best features a prince in disguise—a dramatic irony that tells the audience what kind of reader she is before she knows it herself. Literacy is the film's emblem of emancipation, and the village is its figure of anti-Enlightenment philistinism.

Kant's bearded learned woman returns here in comic dress. A woman who reads is, in the town's eyes, a kind of monster, and Belle and the Beast are prepared, before they meet, for the alliance of monsters Chapter 4 identified. The Beast's gift of his library then translates Virginia Woolf's demand for a room of one's own (1929) into a courtship currency. It is an extraordinary gift and an ambiguous one: the female intellect receives its room as a man's endowment, within a house she did not choose. The film also intimates the Beast's lapsed literacy—it is Belle who reads aloud to him—and so restages Scheherazade with the roles of tutor and tutored reversed.

6.3 Gaston: narcissus, hunter, rival

Gaston fuses two figures from the tradition. He is Beaumont's sister's husband, the handsome man in love with his own face, and he is Cocteau's Avenant, the conventional suitor whose beauty conceals brutality. His song inventories his appetite, from prodigious meals of eggs to a decor composed of antlers, and his proposal sketches a domestic tableau of a wife at his feet and a brood of sons. Carol J. Adams's *The Sexual Politics of Meat* (1990) diagnosed the cultural fusion of carnivory, hunting and the possession of women; Gaston is its cartoon.

René Girard's theory of mimetic desire (1961; 1972) explains his trajectory. Gaston wants Belle because she is the most desirable object in the town and because she refuses him; when the Beast appears as a rival, desire turns to the violence of the double. Susan Jeffords argued that the film splits masculinity in two, the reformable and the incorrigible, and must kill the second in order to redeem the first (Jeffords 1995). Gaston is the masculine remainder the film cannot convert.

6.4 The stained-glass prologue and the masculine rose

The film opens with a narration illustrated in stained glass. The medium is apt: the tale is told as ecclesiastical exemplum, and the window recalls Villeneuve's magic casements. An old beggar woman offers a prince a single rose in exchange for shelter; repelled by her appearance, he refuses; she reveals herself as a beautiful enchantress and transforms him and his household. The lesson is internally contradictory. The prince is punished for failing to see beauty within, yet the punishment is announced by the spectacle of beauty without. The film teaches the anti-physiognomic moral by physiognomic means.

The rose undergoes a decisive transfer. In the eighteenth-century texts it was the daughter's metonym, plucked by the father; here it is the prince's own chronometer, its petals measuring the time until his twenty-first year. The rose has migrated from the economy of female virginity to the clock of masculine maturity. Elizabeth Freeman's concept of *chrononormativity* (2010)—the use of time to bind

bodies to normative life schedules—describes it exactly: the curse is a deadline for heterosexual coupling. Lee Edelman's critique of reproductive futurism (2004) finds its mascot in Chip, the child-cup whose restoration to boyhood guarantees the household's future.

6.5 The West Wing

The Beast forbids Belle the West Wing, where the rose glows under a bell jar. The prohibition fuses Bluebeard's forbidden chamber with Psyche's forbidden sight, and Belle's entry repeats both transgressions. Maria Tatar has shown how the culture of the Bluebeard tale moralised female curiosity (Tatar 2004). Read with Sedgwick's *Epistemology of the Closet* (1990), the West Wing is also a closet: a locked room in which the master keeps the secret of his body and his time. Its violation precipitates rage, flight, the wolves and the rescue. The turning point of the romance is therefore an act of trespass followed by an act of care, and Belle nursing the wounded Beast replaces Belle accused of disobedience.

6.6 The meubles

The film's most consequential invention is the household. The servants are transformed into domestic objects: Lumière a candelabrum, Cogsworth a mantel clock, Mrs Potts a teapot, her son Chip a cup, along with a wardrobe, a footstool and a featherduster. In Villeneuve the service was invisible; in Cocteau it was dismembered; here it is objectified.

Marx's analysis of commodity fetishism provides the uncanny gloss. In the first chapter of *Capital* (1867), a wooden table, once it emerges as a commodity, "stands on its head, and evolves out of its wooden brain grotesque ideas, far more wonderful than if it were to begin dancing of its own accord." The spectacular number "Be Our Guest" literalises the figure: the furniture dances. Lukács's concept of reification (1923) names the converse movement, by which human relations take on the character of relations between things. The castle's servants are reified labour that sings.

The French word for furniture, *meuble*, is the word the Code Noir used for enslaved people. Aimé Césaire's *Discours sur le colonialisme* (1950) condensed colonial domination into the equation colonisation = *chosification*, "thingification," and Hortense Spillers (1987) analysed how the Atlantic slave trade and the law of slavery reduced captive Africans to flesh and property. The Disney film has no colonial intent. But the tale it inherited was told on a ship bound for a slave colony, and its central fantasy—a household whose labourers have been turned into furniture, who remain conscious and cheerful in that condition, and whose deliverance depends entirely on the master's romance—reproduces with startling

fidelity the structure of thingified service. The lapidary remainder of Beaumont's sisters has become a working class.

The structure is reinforced by hospitality. "Be Our Guest" is sung to a prisoner. Jacques Derrida observed that the host is always potentially the hostage and coined *hostipitalité* for the hostility lodged in the very law of hospitality (*De l'hospitalité*, 1997). Belle is the guest-hostage of a house whose staff, as Silvia Federici's critique of unwaged reproductive labour would note, perform care without wages, rights or end. The 1991 film never explains why the servants were cursed for their master's sin. Their humanity is collateral, restored only as a by-product of his.

6.7 The mob

When the magic mirror reveals the Beast to the town, Gaston turns the villagers into a mob. The sequence is prepared by a subplot of startling darkness: Gaston conspires with the keeper of the local asylum to have Belle's father confined as a madman unless she agrees to marry him. Confinement, which Foucault's *Histoire de la folie* (1961) made the emblem of classical reason's exclusions, here serves as an instrument of matrimonial coercion.

The mob's target is a creature it may kill without committing murder. Giorgio Agamben's *Homo Sacer* (1995) recovers precisely this figure from Roman law, the life that may be killed but not sacrificed, and links it to the werewolf, the bandit banished from the city. Girard's *Le Bouc émissaire* (1982) explains the unanimity of the crowd that discharges its violence upon a monstrous victim.

Howard Ashman died of AIDS-related complications in March 1991, eight months before the film's release, and the film is dedicated to him as the man who gave a beast his soul. Collaborators and critics, Sean Griffin among them (2000), have read the Beast—a cursed body under a deadline, hidden in a forbidden wing, hunted by a crowd stirred to fear—as an allegory of the epidemic and of the panic that met it. That panic had named authors. In 1986 William F. Buckley Jr. proposed in *The New York Times* that people with HIV be tattooed; the same year a ballot initiative backed by Lyndon LaRouche's movement, California's Proposition 64, sought to open the way to quarantine and was rejected by voters; and President Ronald Reagan made his first major address on the epidemic only in 1987, six years into it. Simon Watney's *Policing Desire* (1987) showed how the press cast people with AIDS as a menace to a "general public" from which they were excluded, and Leo Bersani's "Is the Rectum a Grave?" (1987) analysed how that discourse figured gay men's sexuality as lethal, while refusing the counter-move of redeeming it by making it respectable. Bersani's refusal is the Gryllean remainder in its sharpest modern form: a defence of the stigmatised that declines to transform him into the norm. Judith Butler's later question, which lives are grievable (2004; 2009), is the film's secret question: the mob grieves Gaston, and only Belle grieves the Beast.

6.8 “I love you”: the regime of avowal

The Beast, stabbed in the back by Gaston, dies in Belle’s arms; her avowal coincides, almost to the instant, with the fall of the last petal. Then the Beast is lifted into the air, light bursting from his hands and feet, and he descends as a man. The iconography is that of the Transfiguration and the Resurrection, and the operative act is a confession of feeling.

Foucault argued in *La Volonté de savoir* (1976) that the West made confession a central technology for producing truth, so that man became “une bête d’aveu”—a beast of confession. Disney literalises the formula: the beast becomes human through an avowal. J. L. Austin’s *How to Do Things with Words* (1962) took the marriage vow as its paradigm of the performative utterance that does what it says; Belle’s “I love you” is a performative whose felicity conditions include sincerity and timing.

The film’s detractors have since diagnosed “Stockholm syndrome,” but the more precise feminist frame is Janice Radway’s analysis of the ideal romance (1984) and Tania Modleski’s of mass-produced fantasy (1982). Both show that the heroine’s labour is hermeneutic: she must interpret male hostility as concealed tenderness until the hero is transformed into a nurturing partner. Jessica Benjamin’s theory of recognition (1988) explains the film’s comparative success: Belle refuses, argues and leaves, and the Beast changes because she does. Yet June Cummins was right that the story belongs to him (Cummins 1995). The 1991 film perfects the regime of *aveu*: the woman confesses, and the man is born.

CHAPTER SEVEN

7

Gans, 2014, and Condon, 2017

Ecology, Trauma, Grace, and the Neoliberal Settlement

7.1 Gans: the golden doe and the return of the teller

Christophe Gans's *La Belle et la Bête* (2014), with Léa Seydoux and Vincent Cassel, returns to Villeneuve rather than to Disney. Belle learns the Beast's history through nightly dreams, as Villeneuve's heroine learned hers, and the history revealed is a crime against nature. In Gans's telling, the prince was a passionate hunter married to a nymph, daughter of the forest's god, who begged him to spare a golden doe; he killed the doe, and it was she. Her father's curse makes him a beast.

The revision is philosophically pointed. Actaeon was punished for seeing a goddess; Gans's prince kills one. The beast's guilt is no longer pride or inhospitality but femicide fused with ecocide: the hunter's violence against the female and the animal at once, the conjunction Carol J. Adams theorised. The curse becomes a juridical response of nature to its despoliation.

Gans also restores the frame. The film is narrated by a mother reading the tale to her children, and she is revealed at the end as Belle herself. The female teller of Apuleius's cave, of Villeneuve's ship and of Beaumont's schoolroom returns as the author of her own story. This is the regime of *récit*: disenchantment ratified by narrative self-possession, the woman who saved the Beast now holding the book in which he is saved.

7.2 Condon: the postfeminist Belle

Bill Condon's live-action *Beauty and the Beast* (2017) is a remake of the 1991 film rather than of any earlier text, and its revisions are corrections. Emma Watson, then prominent as a UN Women Goodwill Ambassador through the HeForShe campaign, publicly declined to wear a corset and played Belle in riding boots. The new Belle is an inventor: she builds a horse-driven washing device so that she may read while the laundry turns, and she teaches a village girl to read, provoking the villagers' punitive sabotage of her work.

The film's feminism is sincere and symptomatic. Ruth Schwartz Cowan's *More Work for Mother* (1983) showed that domestic technologies rarely reduced women's labour; Belle's emancipatory machine is still addressed to the wash. Angela McRobbie (2009), Rosalind Gill (2007) and Catherine Rottenberg (2018) have described a postfeminist or neoliberal sensibility that recodes feminism as individual capability, self-improvement and enterprise. Condon's Belle is its heroine: inventive, literate, entrepreneurial and still contracted to redeem a man.

7.3 The erudite Beast

The most revealing revision concerns the Beast's mind. In Villeneuve and Beaumont his wit was forbidden by curse; in 1991 his literacy was lapsed. Condon's Beast is erudite. He quarrels with Belle about *Romeo and Juliet*, jokes that some of his books are in Greek, and wins her through shared reading. The tradition has restored to the Beast the *esprit* it once required him to hide.

In Bourdieu's terms (*La Distinction*, 1979), the romance becomes a match of cultural capital: the companionate marriage of two readers. The alliance of monsters is reformulated as an alliance of the educated. Something is gained—the woman is no longer asked to love what she cannot esteem intellectually—and something lost. Beaumont's radical proposition, that goodness without worldly wit may merit love, has quietly disappeared.

7.4 Trauma and theodicy

Condon gives both lovers wounds. The Beast was corrupted by a cruel father after his mother's death, and the servants acknowledge that they did nothing to prevent it; Belle's mother died of plague in Paris, a secret revealed when the Beast's enchanted atlas transports them to the garret of her infancy. The two orphans meet as survivors.

Eva Illouz has shown how a therapeutic ethos, fused with emotional capitalism, converts moral failure into psychic injury and redemption into healing (*Cold Intimacies*, 2007; *Saving the Modern Soul*, 2008). In 2017 the Beast's sin becomes a symptom, and his cruelty acquires an aetiology. The servants' complicity supplies a

retroactive theodicy for their thingification, which the 1991 film had left unexplained. The cost is a narrowing of the tale's moral imagination. Beaumont asked whether one could love an ugly but good being; Condon asks whether one can heal a damaged one.

Illouz's *Hard-Core Romance* (2014) traced the same template in E. L. James's *Fifty Shades of Grey* (2011), the decade's most commercially successful romance, whose hero's compulsion to dominate is explained by abuse and neglect in his early childhood, and whose heroine's love promises to heal it. Condon's Beast belongs to the same structure of feeling: a man's cruelty is given its origin in a wound, and the woman is assigned the work of the cure. The anthropogenetic contract survives the therapeutic turn by changing its vocabulary from redemption to recovery.

7.5 Grace after the deadline

In Condon's climax the last petal falls before Belle's avowal reaches the dying Beast. The servants complete their reification and become inert antiques—Madame de Garderobe a mute wardrobe, Maestro Cadenza a silent harpsichord. The lapidary remainder is made explicit: what Beaumont imposed on envious sisters, the remake imposes on loyal workers, and the audience watches persons become furniture without remainder of consciousness.

Then Agathe, the enchantress who has lived in the village as a despised outcast, intervenes and restores everyone. The law of the curse has been fulfilled and is suspended by an act of pardon. Carl Schmitt defined the sovereign as the one who decides on the exception (*Politische Theologie*, 1922); Derrida argued that true forgiveness forgives only the unforgivable, beyond any economy of exchange (*Le Siècle et le pardon*, 1999). The fairy remainder returns as sovereign grace. This is the regime of *grâce*: disenchantment no longer by consent or avowal, but by the discretionary mercy of a feminine power that stands above the contract.

7.6 The digital Beast and the indexical prince

Condon's Beast is a digital creature, animated through performance and facial capture of Dan Stevens; his prince is Stevens's photographed face. The metamorphosis is therefore a passage between ontologies of the image—from the rendered to the recorded. Bazin had grounded cinema in the photograph's indexical trace of a real body. In 2017 the human is precisely what can be photographed, and the beast what must be computed.

The three great films thus map three technologies of the body. Cocteau's Beast was prosthetic and indexical, a real actor under real fur; Disney's 1991 Beast was graphic, a line drawn by Glen Keane; Condon's is synthetic. Jean Baudrillard argued that Disneyland is presented as imaginary to make the rest of the world seem real

(*Simulacres et simulation*, 1981). The live-action remake performs the same operation on the human form: the photographed prince is offered as the real, against the simulated beast. The ontology of cinema becomes the ontology of Man.

7.7 Inclusion and its limits

Condon described a brief sequence involving Gaston's companion LeFou as an "exclusively gay moment," and the film met boycotts and censorship in several markets. The gesture, like the film's colour-conscious casting, enlarges the representational field. Sara Ahmed's *On Being Included* (2012) and Lisa Duggan's critique of homonormativity (2002) nonetheless clarify its limit: inclusion within an unchanged structure may confirm that structure. LeFou is admitted to the story; the anthropogenetic contract is not renegotiated.

7.8 Synthesis: the neoliberal settlement

Gans and Condon pull the tradition in opposite directions. Gans returns it to the female teller and to nature's jurisprudence; Condon modernises Belle while preserving, and in its climax intensifying, the contract and its remainders. The remake's settlement is characteristic of its moment: agency maximised for the heroine, structure unaltered for everyone else. Belle may invent, read and teach, but the human is still manufactured at the end through her love, the servants are still things until the master is saved, and only a sovereign pardon makes the ending happy.

PART

IV

Constellations

Chapters 8–9 · The feminist and humanist traditions

CHAPTER EIGHT

8

Feminist Constellations

Counter-Readings and Counter-Writings

8.1 From the querelle to the rights of woman

The tale's eighteenth-century authors wrote inside a feminist tradition older than the word. Christine de Pizan's *Cité des Dames* (1405) built an allegorical city of women against the misogyny of clerks. François Poullain de la Barre's *De l'égalité des deux sexes* (1673) brought Cartesian method to the question, an argument customarily summarised in the formula that the mind has no sex. Émilie du Châtelet, translating Mandeville's *Fable of the Bees* in the 1730s, wrote in her preface that if she were king she would reform the abuse that cuts off half the human race: "Je ferais participer les femmes à tous les droits de l'humanité, et surtout à ceux de l'esprit" ("I would have women share in all the rights of humanity, and above all in those of the mind").

The sentence joins feminism and humanism in a single clause, and it touches the tale at its crux. The rights "of the mind"—of *esprit*—are exactly what the tale's Beast is forbidden to display and what its Belle is taught to subordinate to goodness. Beaumont's moral and du Châtelet's demand share a horizon of rational humanity and part over the place of wit within it.

Mary Wollstonecraft pressed the critique to its classic form. In *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (1792) she wrote that women, "taught from their infancy that beauty is woman's sceptre," find that "the mind shapes itself to the body, and, roaming round its gilt cage, only seeks to adorn its prison." The Beast's palace, with its apartment inscribed for Belle, its wardrobes and its library, is the gilt cage made literal. Wollstonecraft had also been a governess, and her *Original Stories from Real Life* (1788), in which a wise Mrs Mason instructs two girls through exemplary tales, is the radical heir of Beaumont's Mademoiselle Bonne.

Olympe de Gouges completed the arc. Her *Déclaration des droits de la femme et de la citoyenne* (1791) opened by declaring that woman is born free and remains equal to man in rights, and her play *Zamore et Mirza* (1785, staged 1789) attacked slavery. In de Gouges the two remainders this thesis has traced—the woman as medium and the enslaved person as *meuble*—are named as one injustice.

8.2 The mediating woman and the traffic in women

Beauvoir's analysis of woman as the Other through whom man achieves transcendence (1949) supplies the tradition's master diagnosis: Belle exists in the story so that the Beast may become a subject. Lévi-Strauss's account of kinship as the exchange of women (1949), radicalised by Gayle Rubin (1975) and Luce Irigaray (1977), explains the opening: the rose for the daughter, the daughter for the father's life. Carole Pateman's *The Sexual Contract* (1988) explains the close: the contract that seems freely chosen institutes, beneath its language of consent, a relation of access and subordination. Read together, these texts show that the tale is not merely patriarchal in content but contractual in form. It narrates the founding of a household as a sequence of exchanges, debts and consents, each of which passes through a woman.

8.3 Jane Eyre, Bertha, and the imperial remainder

Charlotte Brontë's *Jane Eyre* (1847) is the nineteenth century's great revision of the tale. Rochester is a beast-master—dark, sardonic, harsh—in a house with a forbidden upper storey; Jane is not beautiful; and the ending refuses metamorphosis. Rochester is maimed and blinded, his hair grown wild like the eagle's feathers of Daniel's Nebuchadnezzar, and Jane marries him as he is: "Reader, I married him." The ending is non-metamorphic, and it is the heroine who speaks the performative.

But the novel's forbidden room holds a woman. Bertha Mason, the Creole wife from Jamaica, is described in the language of the animal: "it grovelled, seemingly, on all fours; it snatched and growled like some strange wild animal." Gayatri Chakravorty Spivak's "Three Women's Texts and a Critique of Imperialism" (1985) argued that the feminist individualism of Jane's ascent is purchased by Bertha's animalisation and self-immolation, and Jean Rhys's *Wide Sargasso Sea* (1966) restored Bertha's history. The structure is exactly the one this thesis has found in the tale: a woman's emancipation achieved alongside, and partly by means of, the thingification or animalisation of colonised others.

Sylvia Wynter's "Beyond Miranda's Meanings" (1990) generalised the point through *The Tempest*. Prospero's island is a household of a father, a beautiful daughter guarded for a prince, and a "monster," Caliban, whom Prospero at last

acknowledges—"this thing of darkness I / Acknowledge mine." Wynter observed that the play has no Caliban's woman: the colonised man is marked as beast, the European woman as the canon of beauty and desirability, and the colonised woman is absent altogether. The *Beauty and the Beast* tradition shares that absence. Its Beast has no female counterpart, and its beauty is, in every canonical version, white. Frantz Fanon (1952; 1961) analysed how colonial settlers and administrators described the colonised in zoological terms; Aimé Césaire (1950) named colonial domination *chosification*. The beast and the thing are the colonial figures the tale domesticates.

8.4 Carter's inversion

Angela Carter's *The Bloody Chamber* (1979) offers two versions. "The Courtship of Mr Lyon" retells the tale in a modern register, faithfully and tenderly. "The Tiger's Bride" inverts it. The heroine, lost by her father to a beast at cards, refuses to be traded as a commodity, strips herself before the beast as he strips before her, and is at last licked by the tiger until her human skin comes away to reveal fur. The woman becomes beast; the beast does not become man.

Carter's companion essay, *The Sadeian Woman* (1979), argued that the myth of feminine virtue rewarded is a trap and that women must become subjects of desire rather than its prizes. "The Tiger's Bride" is the Gryllean remainder become feminist programme. It anticipates Donna Haraway's refusal of origin myths that require the purification of the human (1985), Rosi Braidotti's posthuman feminism (2013), and Deleuze and Guattari's argument that every becoming passes through becoming-woman and becoming-animal, never through becoming-man (1980).

8.5 The look, the romance, and the promise of happiness

Laura Mulvey's account of the male gaze (1975) is complicated by the tale, since its central gaze is the woman's look at a male body. Linda Williams's essay "When the Woman Looks" (1984) supplies the missing frame: in classical horror, the heroine's look at the monster often produces a flash of sympathetic identification, because both are bodies defined as deviant by the masculine order. *King Kong* (1933), whose impresario declares at the end that beauty killed the beast, is the horror-film double of the tale, and its racial and colonial subtext confirms the imperial remainder.

The romance critics locate the tale's mass appeal. Janice Radway (1984) and Tania Modleski (1982) showed how popular romance trains women to interpret masculine hostility as hidden tenderness and promises that patient love will reveal it. Lauren Berlant's *The Female Complaint* (2008) described the sentimental culture in which women's suffering is recompensed by the fantasy of love's eventual

reciprocity, and *Cruel Optimism* (2011) analysed attachments to fantasies that obstruct the flourishing they promise. Sara Ahmed's *The Promise of Happiness* (2010) read the happy ending as a script that directs desire toward approved objects. "They lived happily ever after" is the tale's last and most effective performative.

8.6 The missing female beast

The tradition's structural absence is the beast who is female. D'Aulnoy's White Cat is disenchanted by decapitation. Mary Shelley—Wollstonecraft's daughter—wrote the tale's tragedy in *Frankenstein* (1818). The Creature educates himself by reading *Paradise Lost*, Plutarch's *Lives* and Goethe's *Werther*; he is good until rejection makes him monstrous; and he asks his maker for a female companion, whom Victor tears apart before she can live. The Beast who is never loved becomes a murderer, and the female beast is destroyed unborn.

Popular culture began to answer only late. *Shrek* (2001) inverts the transformation: the princess Fiona, offered a return to human beauty, remains an ogre, and the film counts it a happy ending. Jack Halberstam's *The Queer Art of Failure* (2011) read such animated refusals of normative success as a minor politics. Guillermo del Toro's *The Shape of Water* (2017), which its director framed in part as a reply to the tale, ends with a mute woman transformed toward the amphibian creature she loves. Fatema Mernissi's *Scheherazade Goes West* (2001), reading Kant's gendered aesthetics, argued that the Western harem is the image of feminine beauty itself. The female beast is the figure that would release Belle from that harem, and the canonical tradition never permits her to exist.

CHAPTER NINE

9

Humanism and Its Others

The Anthropological Machine

9.1 The domestic anthropological machine

Giorgio Agamben's *L'aperto: L'uomo e l'animale* (2002) argues that Western thought has never possessed a stable definition of the human. It has instead operated an "anthropological machine" that produces the human by continuously deciding, and re-deciding, what in the human is animal and must be excluded. Agamben notes that Linnaeus could find no specific character for *Homo* other than the injunction *nosce te ipsum*, know thyself: the human is the animal that must recognise itself as human in order to be one.

Beauty and the Beast is this machine in domestic form. Its Beast cannot recognise himself as human; he requires another to recognise him; and her recognition operates the separation, discarding the animal body and producing the human prince. The tale differs from the philosophical machine in one respect only, but it is decisive: the operator is a woman, and her recognition is called love.

Sylvia Wynter's "Unsettling the Coloniality of Being/Power/Truth/Freedom" (2003) gives the machine a history. Wynter argues that Renaissance and Enlightenment humanism produced a particular genre of the human—first the rational political subject, then the bioeconomic subject—which it overrepresented as if it were the human as such, defining its others as lacking reason or civilisation. The prince who emerges at the end of the tale is that genre incarnate: male, sovereign, propertied, European, beautiful. The tale's humanism is real, but it is the humanism of "Man," and the Beast becomes human by becoming him.

9.2 Becoming-animal and the impossibility of becoming-man

Deleuze and Guattari's *Mille plateaux* (1980) dates its plateau on becoming-animal to the year 1730—a decade before Villeneuve. For them, becomings are always minoritarian: one becomes woman, animal, child, molecule, imperceptible; one never becomes man, because man is the majoritarian standard against which all becomings are measured. A becoming is not an imitation or a metamorphosis but an alliance, a zone of proximity in which two terms are deterritorialised together.

In this vocabulary, the canonical ending is not a becoming at all. It is a reterritorialisation onto the majoritarian standard, a return to the molar form of Man. The genuine becomings of the tale lie elsewhere: in Belle's nightly approach to the animal, in the alliance of monsters, in the zone of proximity that Cocteau's drinking scene and Carter's tiger's tongue explore. The transformation abolishes the becoming it was meant to crown.

9.3 Disgust, shame, and the face

Martha Nussbaum's *Hiding from Humanity* (2004) argues that disgust is a refusal of our own animality, projected onto groups made to bear it—women, Jews, homosexuals, the disabled, the poor. Julia Kristeva's *Pouvoirs de l'horreur* (1980) described the abject as what the subject expels in order to constitute its borders. Belle's first response to the Beast is the shudder of disgust and fear, and her moral education consists in its overcoming. The tale is, in this sense, a therapy for projective disgust.

Yet the face remains the test. Emmanuel Levinas grounded ethics in the face of the Other, which commands *thou shalt not kill* (*Totalité et infini*, 1961). In "Nom d'un chien ou le droit naturel" he recalled Bobby, a dog who greeted Jewish prisoners in a Nazi labour camp as men when their guards did not, and called him the last Kantian in Nazi Germany. Levinas nonetheless hesitated over whether an animal has a face in the ethical sense. Derrida's *L'animal que donc je suis* (2006) began from the opposite scene: the philosopher, naked before the gaze of his cat, ashamed, and asking why the tradition from Descartes to Levinas had refused to be seen by the animal.

The Beast is the place where these positions meet. He has an animal's face and a man's shame; he is ashamed to be seen, and he asks to be looked at. The tale answers Levinas's hesitation affirmatively—this face commands—and then withdraws the answer, since it rewards ethical regard with a human face.

9.4 Disenchantment and the dialectic of enlightenment

The word for the tale's climax is also the name of modernity's master narrative. In "Wissenschaft als Beruf" (1917, published 1919), Max Weber described the *Entzauberung der Welt*, the disenchantment of the world through rationalisation. The fairy-tale disenchantment of the Beast and the Weberian disenchantment of the world coincide in more than a pun. Both remove a magical order in favour of a calculable human one, and both leave behind a melancholy for what was lost.

Max Horkheimer and Theodor Adorno's *Dialektik der Aufklärung* (1944/1947) read the Circe episode of the *Odyssey* as an allegory of enlightenment's domination of nature, including the nature within the self, and argued that myth is already enlightenment while enlightenment reverts to myth. Their chapter on the culture industry diagnosed the mass reproduction of standardised fantasies. The Disney castle, in which a candelabrum named Lumière—the singular of *les Lumières*, the Enlightenment—sings to a captive, is their thesis made literal: Enlightenment reduced to a household object performing for a guest who cannot leave.

9.5 The face in the sand

Michel Foucault closed *Les Mots et les choses* (1966) by suggesting that man is a recent invention, perhaps nearing its end, destined to be erased like a face drawn in sand at the edge of the sea. Claude Lévi-Strauss had argued four years earlier, in *La Pensée sauvage*, that the human sciences should aim not to constitute man but to dissolve him. The postwar anti-humanisms treated "Man" as a historical figure rather than a nature.

The tale anticipates both the invention and the erasure. It shows the human as a face that must be drawn—conferred, recognised, made—and it redraws that face, version after version, on the shoreline where the animal tide returns. Its persistence suggests that modern culture has not ceased to need the drawing. Its counter-tradition suggests that it has never ceased to doubt it.

9.6 The double bind of humanism

Humanism and anti-humanism therefore bind the tale in opposite directions. Humanism supplies its noblest claim—that the human is achieved, that ugliness hides worth, that the monster is a failure of perception. Anti-humanism exposes its machinery—that the achievement is performed by a woman, purchased with the labour of things and the exclusion of animals, and crowned with the face of Man. The task of the final chapters is to show that these critiques need not end in either restoration or dissolution, but can be resolved into a different form of humanism.

PART

V

Synthesis

Chapters 10–11 · The anthropogenetic contract and a chiasmatic humanism

CHAPTER TEN

10

Fiat Homo

The Anthropogenetic Contract

10.1 The contract in six clauses

The preceding chapters permit a formal statement. Across its variants, the tale enacts a contract whose clauses may be stated as follows.

1. *Suspension.* A male sovereign's humanity is suspended by a feminine power, as punishment or misfortune, and his outward form is made bestial. Humanity is thereby revealed as a status rather than a nature.
2. *Debt.* A father incurs a debt by taking a rose from an enclosed garden. The rose is the daughter's metonym, and the debt is settled between men.
3. *Substitution.* The daughter takes her father's place, freely and therefore validly, entering the Beast's house as surety.
4. *Probation.* A period of nightly ritual follows—supper, conversation, the question—during which the woman's perception is re-educated by habituation and her moral sense is exercised upon a body she finds repellent.
5. *Fiat.* The woman consents. Her consent is the operative clause: it alone has the power to end the suspension.
6. *Metamorphosis and settlement.* The Beast becomes a man, beautiful and sovereign; the household is restored; rank, property and dynasty are secured; the remainders are expelled or petrified.

The contract is anthropogenetic because its object is the production of a human being. It is sexual in Pateman's sense because the consent on which it rests passes through a woman and institutes a man's household. It is humanist because it holds

that humanity can be lost and regained. And it is patriarchal because the regaining is his, while the labour is hers.

10.2 The Marian fiat

The fifth clause has a theological prototype. At the Annunciation, Mary answers the angel: "Ecce ancilla Domini; fiat mihi secundum verbum tuum" ("Behold the handmaid of the Lord; be it unto me according to thy word," Luke 1:38). Medieval devotion dramatised the consent. In his homilies on the Annunciation, Bernard of Clairvaux represents the angel, and with him all creation and the captive dead, waiting upon the Virgin's reply, as if the redemption of the world hung on a young woman's word.

Belle's "yes" occupies the same structural position. The Beast's word waits on her answer; the household, frozen in its enchantment, waits with him; and her consent makes flesh of a promise. The tale inverts the Incarnation's direction. Where the divine descends into human flesh through a woman's consent, the bestial ascends into human form through it. In both cases the woman is the hinge of a metamorphosis whose subject is someone else.

Julia Kristeva's "Stabat Mater" (1977) and Marina Warner's *Alone of All Her Sex* (1976) analysed the Marian cult as both an exaltation and a confinement of the feminine. Belle inherits both: she is exalted as the one whose word makes a man, and confined to the role of making him. Hence the title of this thesis. *Fiat homo*: let there be man—spoken by a woman, in the grammar of the handmaid.

10.3 Six regimes of disenchantment

The sixth clause is constant in outcome but variable in mechanism, and the variations are historically legible. Each version locates the operative power of consent in a different faculty, and the sequence tracks the history of Western theories of the subject.

VERSION	REGIME	OPERATIVE ACT	THEORY OF THE SUBJECT	PRINCIPAL INTERTEXTS
Villeneuve, 1740	*Copula*	Shared nuptial bed after consent	The embodied, ranked subject of canon law and lineage	Gratian; Bougeant; Marivaux
Beaumont, 1756	*Consensus*	Spoken pledge of marriage	The voluntarist subject of will and moral sense	Ulpian; Peter Lombard; Hutcheson; Astell
Cocteau, 1946	*Regard*	A look of love	The phenomenological subject of the gaze	Sartre; Ovid's Actaeon; Bazin
Disney, 1991	*Aveu*	Avowal of feeling	The confessional, expressive subject	Foucault; Austin; Radway

VERSION	REGIME	OPERATIVE ACT	THEORY OF THE SUBJECT	PRINCIPAL INTERTEXTS
Gans, 2014	*Récit*	The heroine's authorship of the tale	The narrative subject of self-possession	Apuleius's frame; Scheherazade
Condon, 2017	*Grâce*	Sovereign pardon after the deadline	The therapeutic subject redeemed by exception	Schmitt; Derrida; Illouz

Read downward, the table records a migration of the human's source: from the body to the will, from the will to the gaze, from the gaze to confession, from confession to narrative, and finally from the subject to a sovereign power beyond the contract. The last regime is revealing. When the woman's consent arrives too late, the contract fails, and only the fairy's grace saves it. The tradition's most recent version thus concedes that the contract cannot sustain itself.

10.4 Four remainders

Every regime produces remainders, and the tradition's counter-history is the history of their return.

The *Gryllean remainder* is the desire for the Beast as Beast: Plutarch's pig, Cocteau's disappointed audiences, Carter's tiger, Shrek's ogre. The *lapidary remainder* is the consciousness sealed in matter: Beaumont's sisters, Condillac's statue, Disney's *meubles*, the Code Noir's movable persons, Condon's servants turned to antiques. The *fairy remainder* is the feminine sovereignty that curses and cures—Villeneuve's fairy jurisprudence, Beaumont's fairy judge, Condon's Agathe—and then withdraws as the prince assumes his throne.

A fourth remainder is Belle's own desire. The canonical endings presuppose that she wanted the prince. Villeneuve's dreams support the presumption; Cocteau's ending refutes it; Beaumont never asks. What Belle loved was the being who sat with her at nine o'clock, and that being is precisely what the metamorphosis removes. Her desire for the Beast—the alliance of monsters—is the remainder that the contract cannot even name.

10.5 The chiasmus of ladders

The deepest structure of the tale is a crossing of two erotic itineraries. The Beast ascends Diotima's ladder (*Symposium* 210a–212a): he loves Belle first for her beauty and comes to love her goodness, rising from the beautiful body to the beautiful soul. Belle descends it: she begins from the Beast's goodness and comes to accept, and finally to need, his body, descending from the beautiful soul to the ugly flesh. Her motion is incarnational, a kenosis; his is Platonic, an ascent.

The two lines cross at the point of mutual recognition. A chiasmus held open would preserve both directions: the Beast continuing to rise through love, Belle

continuing to descend into fidelity to the actual body. The canonical ending instead collapses the X into a single vertical arrow. The Beast's body ascends into beauty; Belle's descent is cancelled, since there is no longer any ugliness to accept. The tale thus resolves its chiasmus into a hierarchy, and that resolution is the formal signature of the anthropogenetic contract.

10.6 The thesis restated

Beauty and the Beast is the modern West's domestic myth of anthropogenesis. It holds, with the humanists, that humanity is achieved rather than given; it holds, with patriarchy, that a woman's consent is the medium of that achievement; and it delivers its conclusion through an anti-physiognomic moral crowned by a physiognomic reward. Its six regimes of disenchantment chart the history of the consenting subject, and its four remainders chart what that subject has cost. The canonical tale is the most beautiful version of the sexual contract ever devised. The tradition, read whole, is its most persistent critique.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

11

Toward a Chiasmatic Humanism

11.1 Sorcerer love: holding the intermediary open

The normative proposal begins where the tale began, with Diotima. In "L'amour sorcier," her reading of the *Symposium* in *Éthique de la différence sexuelle* (1984), Luce Irigaray dwells on Diotima's account of love as intermediary: a *daimōn* between mortal and immortal, ignorance and wisdom, poverty and resource. Irigaray observes that the speech loses this insight when it subordinates love to procreation and to the ascent toward the immortal Form. Love ceases to be a passage between two and becomes a means to an end beyond both.

The canonical ending of *Beauty and the Beast* commits the same fault. The Beast is Diotima's intermediary Eros, and the metamorphosis converts him into a terminus—the prince, the dynasty, the throne. A chiasmatic humanism would hold the intermediary open. It would treat the Beast neither as a husk concealing a man nor as an animal to be shed, but as the place where two orders meet and are each transformed by meeting.

11.2 Wonder before the other

Irigaray's companion essay, "L'admiration," reads Descartes's *Passions de l'âme* (1649). For Descartes, wonder arises at the first encounter with an object judged new, before we know whether it is good or harmful; hence "l'admiration est la première de toutes les passions; et elle n'a point de contraire" (art. 53). Irigaray proposes wonder as the passion proper to sexual difference: an opening to the other that neither appropriates nor rejects.

The tale's aesthetic economy runs on other passions. Burke's sublime is fear; Nussbaum's disgust is projective rejection; the mob's passion is hatred. Belle's education converts fear into esteem, but esteem is a judgment and wonder is an

opening that precedes judgment. A chiasmatic humanism would ground the encounter between Belle and the Beast in wonder, so that neither must become the other in order to be received. The irony is instructive: the passion that could undo the *bête-machine* comes from the philosopher who invented it.

11.3 Attention and the duty to love the people we see

Iris Murdoch supplies the ethics of perception. In "The Sublime and the Good" (1959) she wrote: "Love is the extremely difficult realisation that something other than oneself is real." In *The Sovereignty of Good* (1970) she described a mother-in-law who comes, through patient and just attention, to see her daughter-in-law not as vulgar but as refreshingly simple—a moral change that alters nothing in its object and everything in the beholder. Murdoch drew the concept of attention from Simone Weil, for whom attention was the rarest and purest form of generosity.

This is the aspectual model of transformation that Perrault's Riquet left open and the canonical tradition closed. It does not require the Beast to change his face; it requires the beholder to change her seeing. Søren Kierkegaard's *Works of Love* (1847) gave the principle its sharpest form in the chapter on the duty to love the people we see: love does not demand that the beloved become another, more perfect person, but loves the actual person as found. A chiasmatic humanism takes this as its rule. Recognition that requires metamorphosis is not recognition but a demand for conformity.

11.4 The chiasm and becoming-with

Maurice Merleau-Ponty's posthumous *Le Visible et l'invisible* (1964) described the chiasm of perception: the seer is also visible, the touching hand is also touched, and both belong to a shared flesh in which the positions remain reversible without ever collapsing into identity. The tale's best scenes are chiasmatic in exactly this sense. In Beaumont's first supper, the Beast asks permission to look and is looked at; in Cocteau's drinking scene, the hand that gives water is also the hand that is drunk from.

Donna Haraway's *The Companion Species Manifesto* (2003) and *When Species Meet* (2008) extend the chiasm across the species line. Haraway describes relations of "becoming-with" in which human and animal are co-shaped without either being reduced to the other's measure. Rosi Braidotti's *The Posthuman* (2013) calls for an egalitarianism of life that does not require the human form as entry ticket. These are not alternatives to humanism so much as revisions of its founding claim. Pico's human was the being without fixed form; a chiasmatic humanism takes that formlessness seriously, as openness to relation rather than as a license to ascend.

11.5 Where feminism and humanism converge

Feminism and humanism are often staged as antagonists: humanism accused of universalising a male subject, feminism of particularising a female one. The tale shows a point of convergence. Feminism refuses the woman's role as medium of another's humanity, as Beauvoir did, and refuses an emancipation built upon thingified others, as Spivak, Spillers and Wynter did. Humanism, at its best, refuses the anthropological machine that manufactures Man by expelling the animal and the thing. Both refusals converge on the same positive demand: recognition without assimilation.

Du Châtelet's sentence can therefore be completed. Women should share in all the rights of humanity and of the mind—and humanity itself should be redefined so that sharing in it no longer requires becoming the beautiful sex, the handsome prince, or the cheerful furniture. This is the content of chiasmatic humanism: a humanism whose centre is a crossing rather than a figure.

11.6 Seven propositions

1. *Humanity is conferred, not possessed; but conferral must be mutual and non-assimilative.* To recognise another as human must not mean to require them to become one's image of the human.
2. *Consent is a relation, not a key.* It cannot be the switch that turns a beast into a man, because consent given as surety is never wholly free.
3. *Love is aspect, not alchemy.* What changes in love is first the beholder's seeing; any other change must be the beloved's own.
4. *Labour must be visible.* A household of enchanted things is a household of hidden persons, and its happiness is not innocent.
5. *The animal is not a husk.* The beast is not packaging around a man; what is animal in the beloved is part of what is loved.
6. *The beautiful and the sublime must be ungendered.* Neither delicacy nor terror belongs to a sex, and the alliance of monsters is an alliance of those the aesthetic order excludes.
7. *The ending must remain open.* Chiasmus, not conversion: the crossing is the form of the relation, not a stage on the way to a throne.

11.7 A chiasmatic ending

The argument permits, by way of illustration, a minimal counter-tale. On the night Belle finally answers, she asks a question of her own: what does the Beast wish to become? He does not know. The palace does not blaze with fireworks; nothing transforms. In the morning the servants are named and paid, and some leave. The sisters are not petrified; they are invited to supper, where envy is answered by conversation rather than stone. The fairy, who has waited three centuries at the edge of every version, is offered a chair. The rose is not plucked but replanted outside the garden wall, among the figures the garden once excluded.

Belle and the Beast continue to sit together at nine o'clock. Neither is redeemed by the other; each is changed by the other's regard. The story ends, as Graffigny's Zilia ended hers, not with a wedding but with the pleasure of existing—and, unlike Zilia, not alone.

CONCLUSION

The Statue and the Rose

In 1754 Condillac imagined a statue whose first experience of the world was the scent of a rose. To itself, he wrote, it would be nothing but that scent; its whole consciousness would be the flower. Two years later Beaumont closed her tale with two statues that kept their reason beneath the stone, condemned to watch a happiness they could not share, while within the palace a beast became a man because a woman said yes. Between the statue that becomes conscious through a rose and the statues that remain conscious in punishment lies the whole philosophical anthropology of the tale: the question of how matter becomes mind, how a body becomes a person, and who is permitted to make that passage.

This thesis has argued that the tradition answers that question with a contract. The human is suspended, tested and conferred; the conferral passes through a woman's consent; the labour that sustains it is hidden in things; and the animal it invokes is finally expelled. From Villeneuve's nuptial bed to Condon's sovereign pardon, the mechanism changes with the history of the subject, but the contract endures. So do its remainders—the beast loved as beast, the conscious thing, the withdrawing fairy, and Belle's own unnamed desire—and their return, from Plutarch's Gryllus to Carter's tiger, constitutes the tradition's counter-history.

The chiasmatic humanism proposed in the final chapter is not a correction imposed upon the tale from outside. It is the tale's own suppressed possibility, glimpsed whenever an audience mourns the Beast, whenever a heroine marries a maimed man as he is, whenever a woman's skin is licked away to fur. It asks that love be a crossing rather than a conversion, that recognition not require resemblance, and that the human be understood as a relation held open rather than a form attained.

In the postscript to her *Déclaration* of 1791, Olympe de Gouges wrote: "Femme, réveille-toi; le tocsin de la raison se fait entendre dans tout l'univers; reconnais tes droits" ("Woman, wake up; the tocsin of reason sounds throughout the universe; recognise your rights"). The enchanted castle has always been a house of sleepers—the frozen servants, the dreaming heroine, the beast asleep beside her on the nuptial night. To wake in it is not to make a man, nor to be made into the beautiful sex, but to look across the table at nine o'clock and see, with wonder,

someone other than oneself who is real.

Foucault predicted that the face of man might one day be erased like a face drawn in sand. The tale has spent three centuries redrawing it. Its last lesson may be that the drawing need not be a portrait of Man at all, but the outline of an encounter—two faces, neither the measure of the other, turned toward each other at the edge of the sea.

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